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Coforge denies any discord in Board

COFORGE has denied there was any discord between non-executive chairman OP Bhatt, non-executive independent director DK Singh and the executive directors before gaps in the internal audit process were flagged by KPMG. **■ PAGE 3**

Saudis shut down oil pipeline after attack

SAUDI Arabia has shut down its East-West pipeline after the vital oil conduit came under aerial attack in the widening Middle East war, threatening to send energy prices even higher. **■ PAGE 16**

Trump: Would love to see united Ireland

US President Donald Trump said on Saturday he would 'love' to see Ireland unify with British-run Northern Ireland. He made the remarks made during a visit to Dublin. **■ PAGE 16**

RBI rejects Tata Sons' bid to remain private

Directs company to go public, comply with NBFC rules

URVI MALYANIA
Mumbai, September 12

THE RESERVE BANK of India (RBI) has rejected Tata Sons' application to surrender its certificate of registration (CoR), as a core investment company (CIC), sources close to the development told FE. The regulator's decision brings



clarity to the status of Tata Sons and closes a key route that the Tata Group's holding company had pursued to avoid a

stock market listing. The RBI is believed to have directed Tata Sons to take steps to fully comply with regula-

tions governing non-banking financial companies (NBFC) classified in the Upper Layer (NBFC-UL). Queries sent to the

RBI elicited no response till the time of going to press. Tata Sons had applied to the RBI in March 2024 to surrender

its CIC registration after pre-paying ₹21,813 crore of debt and turning net cash positive in FY24. The development brings

the long-running question over Tata Sons' listing back into focus at a time when the group holding company is also preparing for a leadership transition. Chairman N Chandrasekaran wrote to the Tata Sons board in August, conveying his decision not to seek reappointment after his current term ends on February 20 next year. The Tata Sons board is scheduled to meet on September 17, when the RBI's latest communication is expected to be discussed.

Continued on Page 2

BORDER PEACE MUST, PM STRESSES DURING MEETING

Modi, Xi vow to address widening trade imbalance

Ties to be guided by mutual respect, interest, sensitivity

MUKESH JAGOTA
New Delhi, September 12

PRIME MINISTER NARENDRA Modi and Chinese President Xi Jinping on Saturday underlined the need to address each other's concerns on trade and economic relations, including New Delhi's widening trade deficit with Beijing, market-access barriers and supply-chain vulnerabilities.

At their meeting on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi, both leaders specifically referred to the "structural trade imbalance and supply chain issues" and facilitation of "meaningful and predictable market access." They agreed that differences should not become disputes and said bilateral ties should be guided by "mutual respect, mutual sensitivity and mutual interest," a statement by the Ministry of External Affairs said. However, the statement made no specific reference to India's policy on foreign direct investment from China, which has seen some relaxation in recent months. Beijing's volatile policies regarding export of critical inputs to India also did not find any explicit mention.

"They (the two leaders) reaffirmed that both countries should take a strategic and long-term perspective of their ties," the MEA statement said. Both leaders also agreed to promote business linkages and greater mobility, while seeking to expand common ground on regional and global



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Chinese President Xi Jinping before the 18th BRICS Summit at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi, on Saturday

PM presses for major reforms at IMF, UN

PRASANTA SAHU & MUKESH JAGOTA
New Delhi, September 12

PM NARENDRA MODI on Saturday called for a restructuring of global institutions and proposed a 10-point action plan for international governance reforms, including in the framing of rules. Addressing the 18th BRICS leaders' Summit here, he said the discussions within the grouping made it clear that the changing global order could not be managed through institutions

issues, it added. Modi stressed that peace and tranquility in the border areas remained essential for

NARENDRA MODI, PM
Pyramid of privilege must give way to partnership

designed for an earlier era. "It is clear from today's discussions that the world's transition cannot be carried out through old institutions," he said in his concluding remarks as the BRICS chair.

Continued on Page 2

the continued development of bilateral relations.

Continued on Page 2

Bring peace to West Asia, Xi urges BRICS members

MUKESH JAGOTA
New Delhi, September 12

IN HIS ADDRESS at the summit, Chinese President Xi Jinping urged the BRICS bloc to be a peacemaker in the West Asia conflict.

China will work with other BRICS members in that role, as the war "does not serve the common interests of the international community," he said.

The Chinese leader called the BRICs a "leading group" in the Global South and a model of self-reliance among emerging and developing countries that should promote innovation-driven development.



PM Narendra Modi with Chinese President Xi Jinping, Russian President Vladimir Putin and other world leaders during the BRICS Summit at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi, on Saturday

NEW DELHI DECLARATION ADOPTED

BRICS Bank to expand with new members, resources

PRASANTA SAHU
New Delhi, September 12

LEADERS OF BRICS countries on Saturday resolved to expand the membership of the New Development Bank (NDB), also known as BRICS Bank, and create new financing mechanisms to support infrastructure and development across the Global South.

As per the New Delhi Declaration adopted by the grouping on Saturday, apart from reforming existing institutions for infrastructure and development financing, the NDB should be strengthened further with a facility for expedited consideration of applications from interested BRICS countries.

Continued on Page 2

DECLARATION HIGHLIGHTS

Greater use of national currencies for cross-border trade, investment

Reform IMF & World Bank with greater voice, representation for Global South

Condemn unilateral tariff & non-tariff measures

Commit to AI cooperation, covering access to AI resources



Advance contingent reserve arrangement reforms to make financial safety net more flexible and responsive

Encourage pilots under BRICS multilateral guarantees

BRICS task force on growth and development established by Indian Chair

Call for restraint and diplomacy in West Asia, stressing uninterrupted trade and energy flows

Establish logistics supply-chain cooperation framework to strengthen connectivity

BRICS pushes local currency trade to cut costs

BRICS countries are pushing for greater use of national currencies in trade and investment and interopera-

bility of their cross-border payment systems to reduce transaction costs, reports Mukesh Jagota **■ PAGE 6**

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India, UAE discuss bigger role for L'IMAD

PM Modi and Abu Dhabi Crown Prince Sheikh Khalid bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan discussed a bigger role for L'IMAD, the UAE's newest sovereign investment fund, in India, reports Mukesh Jagota



IRAN, UAE FIND CONSENSUS IN DECLARATION

CULTURAL DETOUR AT BRICS BAZAAR

HDFC Bank submits 2 names for CEO post

FE BUREAU
Mumbai, September 12

HDFC BANK'S BOARD has submitted names of two candidates to the Reserve Bank of India for appointment as the bank's next managing director and chief executive officer, it said in an exchange notification on Saturday, formally starting the succession process for Sashidhar Jagdishan, who is due to retire later this year. The bank did not disclose the names of the candidates.

Jagdishan, who has led the bank since 2020, is set to step down at the end of his second term in October. The bank will submit the names along with the proposed remuneration for the

SUCCESSION PLAN



Bank did not disclose names of candidates

Deputy MD Kaizad Bharucha rumoured to be top runner for post

Sashidhar Jagdishan due to retire in October this year

candidates to RBI for approval for a three-year term.

Continued on Page 2

Maruti emerges EV export giant

Ships more PVs in Q1 than 16 other carmakers together

VIKRAM CHAUDHARY
New Delhi, September 12

WHILE MARUTI SUZUKI'S domestic market share continues to hover around 40% despite new launches, the carmaker — driven by its all-electric flagship, the eVitara — has quietly emerged as an electric vehicle (EV) export powerhouse, operating as a global production hub for its parent company, Suzuki Motor Corporation (SMC).

Sales data sourced from the industry for Q1FY27 (April-June 2026) reveals that Maruti

GOING GLOBAL

	Units		Q1FY27 share (%)
	FY26	Q1FY27	
Maruti Suzuki	25,549	15,210	97.2
Tata Motors	2,518	401	2.6
Hyundai India	298	24	0.2
Kia India	12	6	0.0
Mahindra	275	NA	---

Suzuki commanded an astonishing 97% market share in EV exports from India, shipping 15,210 units of the eVitara overseas. This builds on the FY26 performance, during which Maruti Suzuki captured nearly 90% of all Indian EV

exports with 25,549 units.

Since the time overseas dispatches of the eVitara began in August 2025 — six months before its Indian launch in February — Maruti Suzuki has cumulatively exported over 46,000 units to

more than 49 countries. These shipments are heading to mature, highly regulated markets such as Japan and Western European nations, where quality benchmarks are stringent but the Suzuki brand value is strong.

The performance is in stark contrast to domestic EV leaders Tata Motors and Mahindra, whose electric offerings have struggled to find traction abroad. In FY26, Tata Motors exported just 2,518 EVs — primarily to developing markets like South Africa, Nepal, Bhutan, and Mauritius — and Mahindra exported merely 275 electric units.

This EV export surge is part of a broader passenger vehicle (PV) export footprint.

Continued on Page 2

Sebi proposes CAS framework changes

KUSHAN SHAH
Mumbai, September 12

THE SECURITIES AND Exchange Board of India (Sebi) on Saturday proposed sweeping changes to the closing auction session (CAS) framework, including two alternative methods for determining the settlement prices of index and single-stock derivative contracts on expiry days. The proposals are part of a consultation paper issued after the regulator said last week that it would review the CAS mechanism and seeks views on expiry-day settlement prices, market timings, order handling and information dissemination.

Continued on Page 2



INTERIM PERIOD BEFORE TRANSITION

Option 1: Final settlement price based on blended VWAP of trades in last 30 minutes of CTS & 10-minute CAS

Option 2: Retains existing method of using VWAP in last 30 minutes of CTS

Comments sought on proposals till October 3

FROM THE FRONT PAGE

Modi, Xi vow to address widening trade imbalance

THE BILATERAL STATEMENT on trade and economic ties comes amid India's ever-increasing trade deficit with China, which went up to \$112.1 billion in 2025-26 from \$99.1 billion in the previous financial year. In 2021-22 it was \$73.3 billion. China in 2025-26 accounted for 33.5% of India's total merchandise trade deficit. Much of the deficit is driven by India's heavy dependence on China for industrial inputs, machinery, electronics components, chemicals, pharmaceutical intermediates and critical minerals. The emerging sectors of exports like electronics and automobiles are heavily dependent on inputs and components from China.

Other than deficit, the dependence has also created vulnerabilities which were exposed in 2025 when China tightened controls on exports of rare-earth elements and permanent magnets. Indian automobile and component manufacturers, heavily dependent on Chinese supplies, faced difficulties obtaining the magnets needed for electric vehicles, hybrid vehicles and other automotive applications.

China's April 2025 controls required exporters to obtain licences for specified rare-earth products and magnets. China controls more than 90% of global rare-earth magnet processing capacity, making alternative supplies difficult to secure quickly.

Indian companies have also faced difficulties in obtaining market access in China. New



PM Modi with Chinese President Xi Jinping and Russian President Vladimir Putin during the Bharat Innovates Exposition at the 18th BRICS Summit, on Saturday

Delhi has repeatedly sought greater access for pharmaceuticals, agricultural products, food items and other goods, while Indian businesses have complained of regulatory, sanitary and other non-tariff barriers. Investment was another part of the economic relationship that has remained constrained since the Covid-19 pandemic. India amended its Foreign Direct Investment policy in April 2020 to require government approval for investments from countries sharing a land border with

India. The move brought Chinese investments under the government route amid heightened concerns over opportunistic acquisitions and national security as valuations of the companies fell during COVID outbreak.

New Delhi has since begun a calibrated relaxation of these restrictions. The government in March 2026 introduced changes permitting certain non-controlling investments of up to 10% by investors from land-bordering countries through the

automatic route, while also creating a time-bound approval mechanism for specified manufacturing investments, including in capital goods, electronic components and solar-cell inputs. The easing reflects the competing economic priorities facing India: reducing excessive dependence on China while allowing access to Chinese capital, technology and manufacturing capabilities where they can strengthen domestic production.

Sebi proposes blended method for derivatives expiry pricing

UNDER THE FIRST option, the final settlement price would be based on a blended volume-weighted average price (VWAP) of trades executed during the last 30 minutes of the continuous trading session (CTS) and the 10-minute CAS. The weights assigned to the two sessions would not be predetermined but would depend on the actual traded value during each period.

The second option would retain the existing methodology of using the VWAP during the last 30 minutes of continuous trading to determine settlement prices. Trades executed during CAS would not be included in the calculation, making the methodology similar to the one followed before CAS was introduced in August. Sebi proposed that the second methodology could continue for at least one year, after which it could transition to the blended VWAP framework based on the liquidity and participation seen in CAS and the familiarity of market participants with the auction mechanism. The regulator said retaining the existing settlement methodology during the interim period would provide continuity and give market participants sufficient time to become familiar with CAS. However, it clarified that the arrangement would only be temporary, with blended VWAP being the intended long-term framework.

Sebi also sought to address sharp movements in the indicative index value during CAS. It noted that market participants had at times misconstrued the index value (IIV) as an actual level reached by the index, even though it was only an evolving indication derived from the indicative equilibrium prices (IEP) of constituent stocks. Citing international practices, Sebi proposed discontinuing the dissemination of indicative index values during CAS. Instead, exchanges would disseminate actual index values, indicative prices of constituent securities and expected settlement prices during the relevant settlement-price determination window. The regulator also noted that the closing price and settlement price of stocks in the futures and options segment could differ



because of the different methodologies used to determine them.

Two alternatives for CAS timings

Sebi further proposed reducing the transition period between continuous trading and CAS to one minute from five minutes, based on feedback from stock exchanges. Under the first timing option, continuous trading in all stocks would continue until 3:30 pm, restoring the schedule followed before CAS was introduced. A 10-minute CAS, including the one-minute transition period, would then be conducted after 3:30 pm, while derivatives trading would remain open for five minutes after the auction and close at 3:45 pm. Under the second, CAS would take place between 3:15 pm and 3:25 pm, including the one-minute transition period, while derivatives trading would continue until 3:30 pm. Under both alternatives, reference prices for CAS would be based on trades executed during the last 15 minutes of continuous trading.

Sebi said the proposal to reduce the post-CAS derivatives trading window to five minutes from 10 minutes followed feedback that there was limited rationale for allowing trading in expiring contracts to continue once price discovery in the underlying security or index had been completed.

However, the regulator proposed retaining a smaller window to allow market participants to manage or reverse positions, particularly in single-stock derivatives, where they may not have been able to complete all desired transactions earlier.

Changes proposed for order modification

Sebi also reviewed the existing 3% price band with-

in which orders can be placed during CAS. While proposing to retain the band to give investors sufficient flexibility to express their views on the appropriate closing price, it suggested changes to the cancellation and modification of orders. Limit orders placed within 1% of the reference price would be allowed to be cancelled or modified during CAS.

Orders placed at or beyond 1% and up to the 3% limit would not be allowed to be cancelled, although they could be modified to improve their price within the prescribed band. The regulator said the change is aimed at reducing significant withdrawals of trading interest at prices far from the reference price while allowing participants to improve their orders in response to evolving demand and supply.

Sebi also proposed allowing unexecuted iceberg orders from the continuous trading session to transition into CAS to improve auction liquidity and ensure that existing trading interest is included in the closing-price discovery process.

Iceberg orders are large orders divided into smaller portions, with only part of the total quantity disclosed to the market at a time. Currently, unexecuted iceberg orders do not transition into CAS because of the auction's disclosure-based framework. Under the proposal, such orders would enter CAS as normal limit orders, with their entire unexecuted quantity disclosed and made available for execution under the auction's order-matching mechanism. Sebi has sought comments from market participants on the proposals until October 3, 2026.

HDFC Bank submits two names for CEO post

KAIZAD BHARUCHA, THE bank's deputy managing director, is rumoured to be the most likely internal candidate to succeed Jagdishan. Other contenders include Anup Bagchi, CEO of ICICI Prudential Life Insurance; Paresh Sukthankar, former deputy MD at HDFC Bank; Vibha Padalkar, CEO of HDFC Life Insurance; Rajiv Sabharwal, CEO of Tata Capital; and Amitabh Chaudhry, CEO of Axis Bank.

The board also approved the reappointment of V Srinivasa Rangan as whole-time director, designated as executive director, for the period of November 23 to November 22, 2027. He currently oversees human resources, corporate legal, group oversight and secretarial functions, investment banking, information security, ethics, and fraud and vigilance. It also approved the appointment of Jimmy Tata as whole-time director, designated as executive director, for three years, subject to RBI approval, and an additional whole-time director position. The bank said the position is "in order to have sharper synergy and oversight, including on the subsidiaries of the bank as well as to have larger pipeline for succession planning" and will be filled in consultation with the incoming MD & CEO.

Pyramid of privilege must give way to partnership, says PM

"REPRESENTATION, RESPONSIVENESS, AND rule-making are all necessary reforms," he added.

Earlier, in his opening statement, Modi displayed New Delhi's impatience with the fact that the International Monetary Fund's (IMF) decision-making process had not been reformed to reflect the changed global economic realities and the growing heft of India and other emerging market economies. International financial institutions must better reflect today's economic realities, he said, adding that voting power, leadership positions and policy priorities should give greater weight to countries driving global economic growth. India has repeatedly pushed for reforms in the Bretton Woods institutions, including the IMF and World Bank, to give developing countries a greater voice in global economic decision-making. "Countries experiencing global economic growth should play an important role in global economic governance," Modi said. India currently holds 2.64% of the

total voting power in the IMF. Modi also made a strong case for reforming the United Nations Security Council, stressing that the issue could no longer be avoided. He called for negotiations to be tied to a definite timeline and clear outcomes.

Modi said AI, cyberspace, outer space, biotechnology and critical technologies will shape future global rules. He stressed that developing countries must have the expertise to help frame these rules, calling for efforts to make the Global South both a "rule-taker and a rule-shaper." Modi said the existing 'pyramid of privilege' structure in global governance must give way to a platform of partnership.

The Prime Minister said the BRICS New Delhi summit showed that despite differences in perspectives, member countries remained committed to strengthening mutual cooperation. "Along with the diversity of our thoughts, our commitment

to BRICS cooperation has also been clearly evident," Modi said.

Modi also underlined the need for the Global South to have a meaningful role in shaping emerging technologies and the rules governing them. He said the gap between decisions taken at the global level and their impact on people on the ground needed to be addressed through greater cooperation. "We have also emphasised that the Global South should be equally involved in the development of future technologies and their rules," he said. The resolution assumes importance amidst rapid adoption of Agentic AI, tokenisation and quantum computing.

The adoption of the New Delhi Declaration provided a clear direction for the group's shared commitments, Modi said, stressing that the real challenge would be turning those commitments into action. "The New Delhi

Declaration adopted today gives a clear direction to our shared commitment. Now it is our responsibility to transform these commitments into strong results," he said.

Outlining a 10-point action plan for global governance reforms, he said BRICS must work towards preparing a reform roadmap by the next summit. He proposed creating a Seafarers Emergency Support Network that would bring together maritime authorities and diplomatic missions of the countries concerned. The network could assist in distress situations, including medical aid, communication with families and evacuation. Modi proposed a BRICS Continuity and Implementation Mechanism. Under the proposal, BRICS could create a secure digital repository to track decisions and initiatives, with each decision linked to a nodal point, a deadline and its implementation status. Looking ahead to the next 20 years of BRICS, Modi called for a new and ambitious agenda that would turn the grouping's growing cooperation into tangible outcomes.

BRICS Bank to expand with new members

"WE ENCOURAGE FURTHER efforts by the Bank (NDB) to expand steadily its capacity to mobilise resources, foster innovation, expand local currency financing, diversify funding sources, and support impactful projects that advance sustainable development, reduce inequality, and promote infrastructure investments and economic integration," the declaration said.

The NDB, which operates under a mandate set in the BRICS Summit in 2014, currently focuses its financing on six primary sectors, including clean energy, transport infrastructure, water and sanitation, social infrastructure and bridging the digital divide. It is designed to support both public and private sector projects through customised financial tools.

One objective of the bank is also to scale up local currency lending. Apart from India, China, Brazil, Russia and South Africa, the UAE, Colombia, Uzbekistan, Egypt, Algeria and Bangladesh are its members. Another set of

countries — Uruguay, Ethiopia, Angola, and Zimbabwe — are listed as prospective members.

The grouping welcomed the launch of the BRICS-NDB knowledge portal to share development experiences, policy innovations and lessons from NDB-financed projects.

The declaration stated that any new quota formula at International Monetary Fund should reflect countries' relative positions in the global economy and increase the quota and voting shares of emerging market and developing economies without reducing the shares of developing countries. It also stressed that the interests of the poorest members should be protected and that voluntary financial contributions should not determine quota allocation, governance representation or voting power.

"We reiterate the urgent need to reform the Bretton Woods Institutions (BWI) to make them more agile, effective, credible, inclusive, fit for pur-

pose, unbiased, accountable, and representative, to enhance their legitimacy," according to the Declaration.

On the IMF, BRICS reiterated its support for quota and governance reforms, calling for the implementation of quota increases agreed under the 16th general review of quotas without further delay and for meaningful quota realignment under the 17th review at the earliest. The declaration stated that any new quota formula should reflect countries' relative positions in the global economy and increase the quota and voting shares of EMDEs without reducing the shares of developing countries. It also stressed that the interests of the poorest members should be protected and that voluntary financial contributions should not determine quota allocation, governance representation or voting power.

The World Bank's shareholding review was similarly identified as a key instrument to strengthen multilat-

eralism and make the institution "better, bigger, and more effective". The declaration welcomed progress on the BRICS Multilateral Guarantees (BMG) initiative, which intends to improve the creditworthiness of development projects, lower financing costs and mobilise private investment. Members called for continued technical work and pilot transactions.

The bloc's Contingent Reserve Arrangement, meanwhile, is being strengthened as a financial safety net, with amendments aimed at making it more flexible and responsive during crises. As per GTRI, the most critical section of the declaration is a paragraph on West Asia where a fine balance is struck by urging both the US-Israel and Iran to desist from attacks and retaliatory strikes. "Given BRICS' conflicting interests and internal constraints, securing consensus on such a clear position represents a major diplomatic win for India," it said.

RBI rejects Tata Sons' plea to remain private

IT IS NOT immediately clear whether the meeting will be advanced or an emergency meeting will be called early next week. Tata Sons did not respond to FE's queries until press time.

Tata Sons has been classified as an Upper Layer NBFC since September 2022. Under the RBI's scale-based regulatory framework, entities in this category are subject to enhanced regulatory requirements, including a mandate to list within three years of being classified in the Upper Layer. That deadline expired in September 2025, but Tata Sons has remained unlisted.

The company had sought to exit the regulatory framework after becoming debt-free in 2024, repaying its outstanding borrowings and applying to surrender its

registration as a core investment company (CIC). When the RBI included Tata Sons in its latest list of Upper Layer NBFCs in August 2026, it said the company's application for deregistration as a CIC remained under examination. Its inclusion in the list, the regulator said, was 'without prejudice' to the final outcome of the application. The RBI's revised scale-based regulatory framework, updated in June 2026, sets an asset threshold of ₹1 lakh crore for classification in the Upper Layer.

Tata Sons reported total assets of ₹2.01 lakh crore as of March 31, 2026, according to its FY26 annual report. Under RBI guidelines, an NBFC seeking exemption from registration must meet prescribed conditions, including not access-

ing public funds, having no customer interface and having assets of less than ₹1,000 crore.

The guidelines allow existing NBFCs that do not access public funds or have a customer interface, including those holding a CoR as Type-I NBFCs, to apply for deregistration by December 31, 2026, provided they meet the prescribed exemption criteria. The RBI guidelines also specify that an NBFC classified in the Upper Layer will continue to be subject to the enhanced regulatory framework for at least five years even if it subsequently ceases to meet the qualifying criteria. The September 11 communication appears to have brought Tata Sons' deregistration effort to a close, potentially intensifying the debate

among its shareholders over whether the closely held holding company should remain private. Tata Trusts, which controls around 66% of Tata Sons through the Sir Ratan Tata Trust and Sir Dorabji Tata Trust, passed a resolution in July 2025 favouring retention of Tata Sons as a private company.

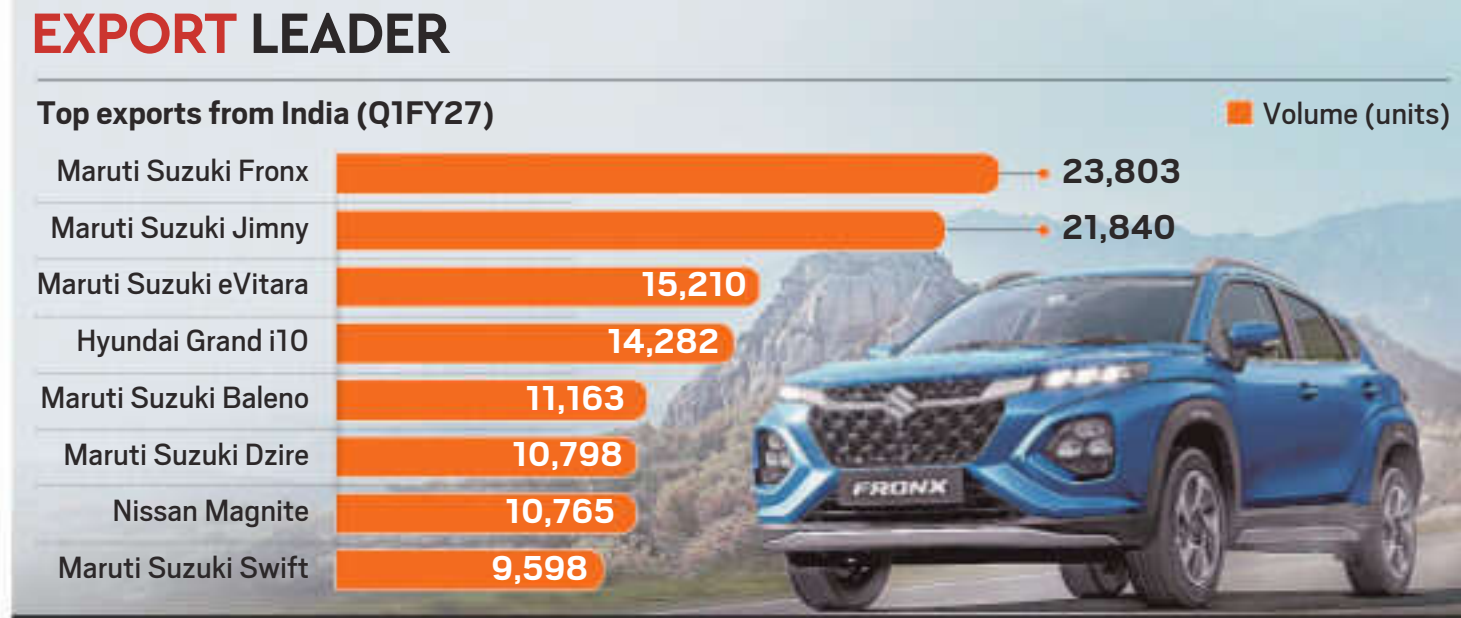
The Shapoorji Pallonji (SP) Group, Tata Sons' largest minority shareholder with an 18.37% stake, has taken a different position, viewing a listing as the most practical way to unlock the value of its holding. The SP Group is seeking to monetise part of its Tata Sons stake to repay a portion of its estimated ₹60,000-crore debt. Some of its Tata Sons shares have also been pledged to raise funds.

(With inputs from Kshipra Petkar)

Maruti Suzuki emerges as electric vehicle export giant

IN Q1FY27, MARUTI Suzuki exported 123,330 PVs, holding 55.5% market share of total Indian PV exports — the carmaker shipped more PVs abroad than all 16 other domestic carmakers combined. In addition, six of the top eight exported PV models from India in Q1FY27 belonged to Maruti Suzuki, led by the Fronx (23,803 units), the Jimny (21,840 units), and the eVitara (15,210 units), which ranked as India's third highest-exported car model overall.

"What we are seeing is a strategic division of labour," noted a senior auto analyst tracking global supply chains. "While the domestic market has become a cut-throat com-



petitive arena, SMC is leveraging India's cost structure to build a high-margin export factory, and today India is the sole global manufacturing hub for models like the

eVitara and the 5-door Jimny." Maruti Suzuki's export performance also drew praise from the government at the 66th SIAM Annual Convention where the

Union Minister for Commerce and Industry Piyush Goyal lauded the carmaker for driving India's automotive exports.

"The only statistic that I

can recognise and appreciate is the million cars that you exported last year," Goyal told industry leaders at the convention. "Maruti is today exporting probably half of those, and is now exporting electric cars, even supplying to Japan. If we do what Maruti has started doing, I would urge all of you to look at export markets more actively and aim to double exports every two years."

With the India-UK Free Trade Agreement in effect and an EU trade deal on the horizon, Maruti Suzuki's early-mover advantage in high-standard EV exports positions it to lead India's next phase of global automotive manufacturing.



Message from the Chargé d’Affaires



YUDHO SASONGKO

Chargé d’Affaires of Indonesia to India and Bhutan

As Indonesia celebrated the 81st anniversary of its Independence and India rejoiced at its 80th Independence, both in August, it is a fitting moment to reflect upon the enduring bonds of friendship that unite Indonesia and India. This occasion reminds us of the sacrifices and perseverance of the founders of our nations, and of a partnership grounded not only in geographical proximity but in shared history, values, and aspirations.

Indonesia and India are maritime neighbours, cultural cousins, and partners in the quest for freedom and dignity. Our peoples drew strength from each other’s struggles for independence, inspired by leaders such as Sukarno, Nehru, Sjahrir, and Biju Patnaik, who envisioned a world where sovereignty, solidarity, and justice would guide international relations. That spirit found expression in the 1955 Bandung Conference, which laid the foundation for the Non-Aligned Movement and continues to resonate today as a pillar of cooperation across the Global South.

The past two years have raised the Indonesia-India partnership to a new level. In January 2025, President Prabowo Subianto paid a visit to India as Chief Guest at the 76th Republic Day celebrations, and Prime Minister Narendra Modi returned the favour by undertaking a visit to Indonesia in July 2026. Exchanged within eighteen months, these visits produced a substantive cooperation agenda spanning defence and maritime security, critical minerals, digital transformation, health, agriculture, and education, which further provides our relationship with a strategic depth commensurate with the weight our two nations carry in Asia and beyond.

Culture and heritage remain the soul of this partnership. The joint restoration of the Prambanan Temple Compounds, the designation of 2026–2027 as the Tagore–Dewantara Year of Cultural and Educational Diplomacy, joint tourism promotions, expanding air connectivity, and growing academic collaboration have brought our peoples closer than ever, sustaining a dialogue between our artistic and spiritual traditions that is far older than our republics. Above all, our vibrant and forward-looking young generations hold the key to ensuring this partnership continues to flourish.

Looking ahead, our two countries stand as partners in shaping inclusive cooperation in this multipolar world through ASEAN - India frameworks, the G20, and BRICS. Indonesia’s accession to BRICS as a full member in January 2025 opens a further avenue for a common purpose. Within BRICS, Indonesia seeks a fairer international architecture in which the voice of the Global South is properly represented. We therefore look forward with anticipation to the fruitful results of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi on 12 - 13 September 2026.

I express my appreciation to The Indian Express for providing a platform to showcase the richness of our bilateral ties, and my gratitude to all friends of Indonesia and India who continue to nurture this friendship. Our two nations have always walked side by side as partners in dialogue, diversity, and dignity, and will keep doing so.

Terima kasih. Dhanyavaad. Thank you.

“India – Indonesia: Shared Civilizational Heritage”



India and Indonesia share a deep cultural bond shaped by centuries of exchange. From the enduring stories of the Ramayana and Mahabharata to art, architecture, and spiritual traditions, the shared heritage continues to connect the two nations.

India is also an important tourism market for Indonesia, with growing interest among Indian travellers. This reflects the strong cultural affinity between the two countries and offers significant opportunities to further strengthen tourism exchanges and people-to-people connections.

The recent visit of Prime Minister Modi to the iconic UNESCO World Heritage listed Prambanan Temple Complex in Yogyakarta, alongside President Prabowo Subianto, further highlighted these enduring ties. The leaders unveiled a plaque marking the commencement of the Archaeological Survey of India’s (ASI) conservation and restoration project at the temple complex.

During the visit, Prime Minister Modi was also conferred with the Bintang Adipurna (Star of the Republic of Indonesia), Indonesia’s highest civilian honour, reflecting the deepening ties and close friendship between the two countries.

Built in the 9th century, Prambanan is Indonesia’s largest temple complex dedicated to the Trimurti—Lord Brahma, Lord Vishnu, and Lord Shiva. Its magnificent architecture and spiritual legacy stand as an enduring symbol of the shared civilizational heritage between India and Indonesia.

Further strengthening these cultural links, the two countries have designated 2026–2027 as the Tagore-Dewantara Year, aimed at promoting closer cultural and educational exchanges. The initiative commemorates the historic meeting in Yogyakarta in 1927 between Indonesian education pioneer Ki Hajar Dewantara and Indian poet, philosopher, and Nobel laureate Rabindranath Tagore.

Rooted in Indonesia. Growing with the world

Indonesia has always been more than our country of origin. It is the ground beneath everything we have built.

For over four decades, APP Group has grown from an Indonesian enterprise into one of the world’s leading pulp and paper companies with manufacturing, distribution, and partnership networks spanning more than 150 countries. Yet through every stage of that journey, Indonesia has remained our anchor, the source of our raw materials, the home of our largest operations, and the wellspring of the values that define how we do business.

Today, as President Prabowo Subianto visits New Delhi for the BRICS Summit, APP Group joins in extending a warm and respectful

welcome. His Excellency’s presence at this forum is a testament to Indonesia’s growing stature as a global economic force and a moment of pride for every Indonesian enterprise operating on the world stage.

The BRICS nations are not abstract geopolitical designations to us, they are markets where our products reach end-consumers, countries where our partnerships have helped build supply chains, and nations whose sustainable development aspirations align with our own.

At the same time, we recognise that economic ambition must be matched by environmental responsibility. APP Group has spent years building operations that respect the natural systems

underpinning Indonesia’s long-term prosperity, from responsible land management to investments in cleaner production across our mills. As we continue to supply packaging, tissue, and printing products to BRICS nations and beyond, sustainable stewardship remains inseparable from how we grow.

The BRICS Summit in New Delhi is an opportunity for dialogue, for partnership, and for the kind of durable multilateral cooperation that creates shared prosperity. APP Group is proud to support Indonesia’s voice in that conversation.

Selamat datang, Bapak Presiden. The world is watching—and Indonesia is ready.

refined petroleum products, meat, and pharmaceuticals. Overall, the trade relationship remains significantly tilted in Indonesia’s favour.

Indian companies have invested more than US\$1.5 billion in Indonesia across nearly 7,300 projects since 2000, with significant contributions from Tata Power and Adani in the energy and mining sectors, TCS, HCL, and Tech Mahindra in information technology, as well as pharmaceutical majors such as Dr. Reddy’s and Aurobindo, alongside financial institutions including SBI and Bank of India. In contrast, Indonesian investments in India total around US\$668 million since 2000 and are concentrated in palm oil and agribusiness, infrastructure, and consumer goods through approximately 100 companies.

With BRICS providing an expanded platform for economic collaboration, the India-Indonesia partnership, underpinned by strong linkages in energy, pharmaceuticals, technology, and agricultural trade, is well positioned to serve as a key example of South-South economic cooperation.



Sohrab Bararia, Partner and Leader - Global Trade & Incentives Advisory, Grant Thornton Bharat

India-Indonesia Expand Cooperation

Health is emerging as a key pillar of the India-Indonesia Comprehensive Strategic Partnership, with the two countries expanding cooperation across healthcare delivery, affordable medicines, medical education, hospital investments and traditional medicine.

Through an Implementation Arrangement on Professional Health Workforce Development, India and Indonesia are creating opportunities for fellowships, specialised clinical training, skills enhancement and the exchange of medical expertise—strengthening healthcare capabilities while deepening professional and people-to-people ties between the two countries.

India’s Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) and Indonesia’s Food and Drug Authority (BPOM) are working together on the regulation of medical products. This cooperation will simplify approval processes and facilitate the movement of quality Indian pharmaceutical products into the Indonesian market.

India’s globally recognised strength in generic medicines also offers significant opportunities for Indonesia. Greater trade in medicines and pharmaceutical components can help diversify and strengthen supply chains, while supporting access to quality and affordable treatments.

Indian Private-sector healthcare providers are expanding their footprint in Indonesia, with Apollo Hospitals partnering with the Mayapada Group on the Mayapada Apollo Batam International Hospital.

Indian Private-Sector healthcare providers are expanding their footprint in Indonesia, with Apollo Hospitals partnering with the Mayapada Group on the Mayapada Apollo Batam International Hospital. The venture is expected to enhance specialised healthcare services while supporting Indonesia’s ambitions in medical tourism.

Cooperation between India’s Ministry of AYUSH and Indonesia’s BPOM on traditional medicine quality assurance aims to promote the safe and regulated development of Ayurveda and Indonesia’s traditional wellness practices.

Together, these initiatives show that India-Indonesia health cooperation is moving beyond conventional diplomacy. By connecting medicines, medical professionals, hospitals, technology and traditional knowledge, the partnership is creating new pathways towards more accessible, affordable and capable healthcare systems.

Indonesia's SEZs: A Gateway for Indian Investment

As India hosts the 18th BRICS Summit, the grouping’s growing economic weight offers an opportunity to translate diplomatic ties into greater trade, investment and business linkages. For Indian companies, Indonesia, which joined BRICS in 2025, with its strategic location, large market and access to ASEAN, can serve as an important gateway to Southeast Asia.

Indonesia manages over 25 active Special Economic Zones (SEZs), which offer sector specific infrastructure and investment incentives. For Indian healthcare companies, Batam’s Health SEZ presents opportunities in medical research, advanced diagnostics, pharmaceuticals and international healthcare services.

Kendal and Sei Mangkei can attract manufacturers in areas such as electronics, EV components and agro-processing, while East Java’s Singhasari SEZ offers prospects in digital services, tourism and high-technology education.

The attraction is not merely geographical, SEZs provide Indian investors with a range of fiscal, customs and administrative incentives, including:

● **Tax holidays:** Corporate income tax reductions of up to 0% for periods of 10–20 years, depending on the scale of qualifying capital investment, including investments above IDR 100 billion.

● **Import and VAT exemptions:** Exemptions or relief from import duties and VAT on qualifying raw materials, factory equipment and capital machinery.

● **Greater foreign ownership flexibility:** Relaxation of certain restrictions under Indonesia’s national Positive Investment List, enabling 100% foreign ownership in eligible activities within designated SEZs, subject to applicable regulations.

● **Regional market access:** Indian enterprises can use Indonesian SEZs as a gateway to the 680-million-strong ASEAN market and wider RCEP markets, benefiting from preferential tariff access subject to applicable trade agreements and rules of origin.

The BRICS Summit can serve as a platform to deepen India-Indonesia business ties. A focused SEZ investment dialogue could translate strategic cooperation into factories, technology partnerships, healthcare ventures and jobs.



IIM Bangalore Campus Deepens India–Indonesia Ties

Indian Institute of Management Bangalore (IIMB) is establishing its first international campus at the Singhasari Special Economic Zone (SEZ) in Malang, Indonesia, marking a major step in the global expansion of Indian higher education and India–Indonesia cooperation.

The campus serves Indonesian students and professionals while also attracting learners from across the ASEAN region. It follows a two-phase model, beginning with Executive Education Programmes for senior executives, business leaders and public-sector professionals, followed by degree-granting management programmes.

Its curriculum focuses on emerging areas such as artificial intelligence, digital transformation, global supply chains, climate and sustainability, and healthcare management. The initiative also promotes research, faculty development, consulting and industry collaboration.

The campus has significance beyond education. By connecting students, academics and business leaders, it strengthens people-to-people and business ties and gives India a stronger knowledge presence in ASEAN. It complements growing cooperation in trade, technology, critical minerals, maritime security and defence.

The initiative supports the internationalisation objectives of National Education Policy 2020 and has the potential to position Singhasari as a

regional hub for management education and leadership development.

IIMB's Indonesia campus thus represents a new chapter in India's educational outreach and an important instrument of knowledge diplomacy and long-term India–Indonesia engagement.



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Indonesia is stepping up efforts to tap India's vast wedding industry, estimated at \$60–75 billion and considered the world's second-largest wedding market after the US. With destination weddings gaining traction among affluent Indian travellers, Bali is emerging as a key focus of Indonesia's outreach. Wedding tourism has been identified as a priority segment alongside honeymoons, family travel and MICE.

Bali's deep-rooted Hindu heritage gives the island a natural cultural affinity with Indian couples. Its temples, traditions and ceremonies offer families the opportunity to incorporate familiar customs into their celebrations. Luxury resorts in Nusa Dua, Jimbaran and Ubud add to the appeal, offering event spaces, accommodation and wellness facilities, along with an expanding range of Indian, vegetarian and Jain culinary options.

Indonesia is also deepening its engagement with Indian wedding planners and the travel trade through familiarisation trips, B2B meetings, sales missions and destination showcases.

With outreach expanding across major Indian cities, the country is presenting Bali and other destinations as a combination of cultural familiarity, tropical settings and international hospitality. The growing focus on weddings also offers a new avenue to deepen tourism and people-to-people ties between India and Indonesia.

Strengthening Defence Ties

India–Indonesia defence ties are entering a new phase. What began with military exchanges and maritime cooperation is increasingly expanding into defence trade, technology and industrial partnerships, reflecting growing strategic convergence between the two countries in the Indo-Pacific.

The 2018 Defence Cooperation Agreement strengthened institution-

alised military engagement, including regular Army-to-Army Staff Talks. Exercises such as Garuda Shakti and the multilateral KOMODO have further enhanced interoperability and operational cooperation.

Maritime security remains central to the relationship. Since 2002, the Indian and Indonesian navies have conducted coordinated patrols in the Indian Ocean, contributing to the security of vital sea lanes and reflecting their shared interest in a stable and secure Indo-Pacific.

The relationship has gained further momentum through defence-industrial cooperation. The recent BrahMos contract with Indonesia's Ministry of Defence marks a significant milestone for India's defence exports and its growing presence in Southeast Asia. BrahMos, one of the world's fastest cruise missiles, can travel at Mach 2.8–3.0 and has an export range of up to 290km.

An agreement between Bharat Dynamics Limited and Indonesia's defence holding company Republikorp for the Astra beyond-visual-range air-to-air missile further expands this cooperation. With the Astra Mk-1 being integrated onto Indonesian fighter aircraft, the partnership is increasingly moving towards defence technology and equipment collaboration.

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APP Group welcomes BRICS Summit India 2026 and reaffirms its commitment to sustainable growth, trade, and cooperation across BRICS Economies.

APP Group is a holding company for multiple Indonesian pulp and paper manufacturing and forestry entities, delivering quality products to meet the growing global demand for pulp, paper, packaging and tissue. As a sustainable and responsible business, we create products and operate with care for our employees, society and the environment.

Innovating today for a sustainable tomorrow.





BRICS INDIA 2026

SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 13, 2026



Prime Minister Narendra Modi welcomes (from left) Brazil's Foreign Minister Mauro Vieira; South African President Cyril Ramaphosa; Ethiopian Prime Minister Abiy Ahmed; and Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto at the BRICS summit on Saturday

DEEPENING INVESTMENT TIES

India seeks bigger role for UAE's new \$300-bn fund

New sovereign fund to expand in emerging sectors

MUKESH JAGOTA
New Delhi, September 12

PRIME MINISTER NARENDRA Modi and Abu Dhabi Crown Prince Sheikh Khaled bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan on Saturday discussed a bigger role for L'IMAD, the UAE's newest sovereign investment fund, in India, as the two countries look to deepen investment ties in strategic and emerging sectors.

At their meeting on the sidelines of the 18th BRICS Summit, the leaders welcomed UAE-based International Holding Company's (IHC) proposed \$11.5-billion integrated greenfield aluminium project in Odisha, described as India's largest integrated aluminium investment. The project is expected

GROWING FOOTPRINT

■ International Holding Company proposes \$11.5-bn integrated aluminium project in Odisha

■ The project is expected to strengthen Odisha's position as a global aluminium manufacturing centre

■ L'IMAD, the newest sovereign investment fund, was created by consolidating ADQ's assets & investments

■ ADIA and Mubadala already have major India exposure, including investments in Jio, Reliance Retail & Tata Power



PM Narendra Modi with Abu Dhabi Crown Prince Sheikh Khaled bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, on Saturday

to strengthen Odisha's position as a global aluminium manufacturing hub and underscores the UAE's growing interest in large-scale Indian industrial projects. The two leaders specifically noted the potential of L'IMAD to deepen the India-UAE partnership, while also discussing

cooperation in defence, space, nuclear energy, technology and innovation, according to a statement by the Ministry of External Affairs. L'IMAD is a new Abu Dhabi sovereign investment platform created after the consolidation of ADQ's assets and investments. With an estimated

asset base of around \$300 billion, it has inherited ADQ's investments and is focused on sectors including energy, infrastructure, logistics, ports, aviation and industry.

Its India-linked portfolio includes ADQ's earlier investment in Tata Motors' electric-vehicle business.

India is now seeking to attract more UAE sovereign capital into infrastructure, strategic industries and emerging technologies.

The UAE already has substantial sovereign investment exposure to India through Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA) and Mubadala. Abu Dhabi Investment Authority is an anchor investor in the National Investment and Infrastructure Fund, while Mubadala has invested in Jio Platforms, Reliance Retail and Tata Power Renewable Energy.

The meeting followed high-level exchanges this year, including UAE President Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan's visit to India in January and Modi's visit to the UAE in May.

The two leaders also welcomed the UAE's active participation in BRICS under India's chairmanship and reaffirmed the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership spanning political, commercial, energy and people-to-people ties.

TO REDUCE TRANSACTION COSTS

BRICS nations push for local currency in trade

MUKESH JAGOTA
New Delhi, September 12

BRICS COUNTRIES ARE pushing for greater use of national currencies in trade and investment and interoperability of cross-border payment systems to cut transaction costs, even as the grouping stepped up criticism of unilateral tariffs and protectionist measures. "There is no proposal in the BRICS for a BRICS currency. The focus is how we can do more intra-BRICS trade and how we can engage with the global business community more actively and reduce transaction costs through trade in national currencies," Secretary (Economic Relations) and India's BRICS Sherpa Sudhakar Delela said.

The New Delhi Declaration adopted at the 18th BRICS Summit said members were working towards interoperability of payment and messaging channels and exploring practical mechanisms for cross-border payments. It also backed discussions on trade settlements and investments using BRICS local currencies, while stressing there would be no "one-size-fits-all" approach.

The push comes amid growing fragmentation in global trade and rising tariff barriers. The declaration expressed "serious concerns" over unilateral tariff and non-tariff measures that distort trade and are inconsistent with World Trade Organization (WTO) rules. It warned that rising tariffs, non-tariff barriers and protectionism in the guise of environmental objectives could reduce global trade, disrupt supply chains and increase uncertainty in international economic activity. BRICS opposed unilateral, punitive and discriminatory measures imposed in the name of climate policy, including CBAM, saying such measures could place additional burdens on developing countries. The group has reaffirmed support for a non-discriminatory, open, equitable, transparent and rules-based multilateral trading system with the WTO at its core.

The declaration said the multilateral trading system had "long been at a crossroads" and called for the WTO to become more responsive to trade disruptions and the needs of emerging markets and developing economies.

COST FOCUS



NO BRICS CURRENCY
Focus is on using national currencies for intra-BRICS trade and investment

CROSS-BORDER PAYMENTS
Members seek interoperable payment systems to lower transaction costs

TARIFF PUSHBACK
BRICS criticised unilateral tariffs, non-tariff barriers and protectionism

WTO AT THE CORE
Called for a fully functioning two-tier dispute settlement system and a stronger WTO

STRONGER VALUE CHAINS
Global Value Chains Action Plan 2026-30 aims to help developing economies move up the value chain

A key demand is the immediate restoration of a fully functioning, two-tier, binding WTO dispute settlement mechanism and the appointment of new Appellate Body members. The dispute settlement system has remained effectively paralysed since December 2019 after the US blocked appointments to the Appellate Body.

BRICS also reiterated support for the WTO's foundational principles, including most-favoured-nation treatment and special and differential treatment for developing countries, particularly least developed countries.

The grouping endorsed further work on the Global Value Chains Action Plan 2026-2030, with a focus on helping emerging and developing economies move up the value chain. It also called for greater trade facilitation, connectivity, critical infrastructure, technology access and digitisation of global value chains.

The declaration also sought to ease financing constraints faced by export-oriented micro, small and medium enterprises. It backed digital and platform-based trade-finance mechanisms and the study of an invoice-discounting mechanism under the Jaipur Consensus to help MSMEs unlock working capital.

Special Economic Zones (SEZs) are also being positioned as hubs for trade, investment, industrial cooperation and integration into resilient global value chains, while BRICS members plan greater cooperation on digitising trade documentation.

At the broader level, leaders endorsed continued progress on the Strategy for BRICS Economic Partnership 2030 as the overarching framework for closer economic cooperation and commended India for steering its development during its 2026 chairship.

FM, AIIB chief discuss ways to further ties

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 12

FINANCE MINISTER NIRMALA Sitharaman on Saturday met Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) President Zou Jiyang, on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit, and discussed opportunities to further deepen the India-AIIB partnership.

"They discussed opportunities to further deepen the India-AIIB partnership, support India's infrastructure and transport connectivity priorities, enhance local-currency financing, increase private sector participation and global presence of AIIB," the finance ministry said in a post on X.

Iran, UAE find consensus at BRICS

SHUBHAJIT ROY
New Delhi, September 12

AS THE SIX-month-long West Asia war flares up with US and Iran exchanging strikes, India achieved the much-anticipated – and the much-fraught – consensus at the BRICS summit between UAE and Iran after hectic negotiations paving the way for the joint declaration adopted Saturday.

Against this backdrop, UAE's crown prince Sheikh Khaled bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, who is the Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi, met Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian on the margins of the BRICS summit.

In paragraph 28 of the joint declaration, the BRICS leaders said, "We express deep concern



Iran President Pezeshkian with UAE Crown Prince Khaled bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan

over the continued escalation of tensions in Middle East/West Asia and, recalling our respective national positions, call for exercising maxi-

mum restraint, as well as avoiding actions that could further aggravate the situation."

The declaration acknowledged the sensibilities of both

sides by flagging territorial sovereignty and the need to secure civilians and infrastructure. UAE has been at the receiving end of a series of Iranian strikes on its cities with Tehran calling it a proxy of the United States. In addition, the declaration underscored dialogue and diplomacy and smooth flow of energy – all important issues and challenges faced by all the countries from the developing countries.

"We encourage increasing efforts, through dialogue and diplomacy, towards a long-term understanding that will contribute to lasting peace, security and stability in the region. We stress the need to work together to maintain smooth flow of global trade, supply chains and energy, in accordance with applicable international law."

Delegates get to enjoy shahtoot phirni, cultural performances at gala dinner

ANI
New Delhi, September 12

PRIME MINISTER NARENDRA Modi hosted a gala dinner for BRICS leaders and delegates at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi on Saturday, with Russian President Vladimir Putin, Kazakhstan President Kassym-Jomart Tokayev, Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto and World Health Organization Director-General Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus among those attending the event.

The dinner was held for global leaders and delegates attending the 18th BRICS Summit, under India's chairship. Union Ministers Nirmala Sitharaman, Kiren Rijiju, Sarbananda Sonowal and Arjun Ram Meghwal, along with Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath and other chief ministers, travelled together by bus for the dinner. Union Home Minister Amit



PM Narendra Modi with BRICS leaders applaud as they watch artists perform at the dinner

Shah, Union Health Minister JP Nadda and Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla also left for the venue along with other ministers.

The vegetarian menu for the BRICS Leaders' Dinner brought together a curated selection of regional Indian delicacies, offering world leaders a taste of the country's diverse culinary traditions. The meal began with *Khandvi Mille-Feuille*, a steamed gram-

flour roll tempered with mustard, coconut and curry leaves, and *Khumb Galouti*, tender pan-grilled mushroom kebabs served with mint pearls and sheermal. The main course featured *Paneer Lababdar*, *Gucchi Marmik* made with Himalayan morel mushrooms and asparagus, Carrot Bean *Poriyal* prepared with South Indian spices and coconut, *Thakkali Belle Saaru*, millet *pulao*, beetroot

raita and assorted Indian breads. Desserts included Old Delhi's Fruit Cream with *alebi* and *Shahtoot Phirni*, a slow-cooked milk-and-rice pudding topped with mulberries and gold leaf. The menu brought together flavours from the Himalayas, South India and Old Delhi, highlighting the breadth of India's regional culinary heritage.

A special cultural performance, *Navarasa – The Universe of Shared Emotions*, was presented during the gala dinner. The programme also featured the BRICS Symphony, *One Rhythm, Many Cultures*, bringing together musicians from BRICS member and partner countries in a collaborative musical performance.

Drawing on diverse musical traditions, the symphony sought to showcase a shared artistic expression reflecting the cultural richness, diversity and spirit of togetherness of the BRICS family.

Cultural detour at BRICS Bazaar

ANI
New Delhi, September 12

DAUGHTER OF IRANIAN President Masoud Pezeshkian, Zahra Pezeshkian, and her husband, Hassan Majidi, visited the BRICS Bazaar at the National Crafts Museum on Saturday, exploring textiles, handicrafts and cultural displays representing BRICS member and partner countries. The visit, shared by the official Iranian Embassy in India account, added a cultural dimension to the ongoing BRICS engagements in the capital.

Videos from the bazaar show Zahra in a black abaya viewing textile and craft displays, including the Iranian showcase, and posing for photographs with Indian representatives in front of a BRICS India 2026 backdrop.

Union Minister for Women and Child Development and Kodarma Lok Sabha MP Annapurna Devi also shared a carousel of



Zahra Pezeshkian (right), daughter of Iranian president, with artisans at the bazaar on Saturday

photographs from the visit. Welcoming Zahra to the bazaar, she wrote, "It was a pleasure to welcome Ms Zahra Pezeshkian, daughter of Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, to the BRICS Bazaar at the National Crafts Museum, New Delhi."

The BRICS Bazaar, being held at the National Crafts Museum and Hastkala Academy from September 10 to 15, places traditional

craftsmanship at the centre of the wider BRICS programme in New Delhi.

The exhibition features textiles and crafts reflecting the distinct cultural traditions of participating countries, including woven stripes and ikat motifs, brocade and jacquard work, and printed and dyed cotton and silk textiles. Country panels represent Iran, India, China, Brazil, Bolivia, Egypt, Ethiopia,

Indonesia, Kazakhstan, Russia, Saudi Arabia, South Africa, Thailand, the United Arab Emirates, Uzbekistan, Cuba, Belarus, Malaysia, Nigeria, Uganda and Vietnam, alongside additional partner and member-country displays. The Iranian panel forms part of a broader textile installation bringing together regional weaving, printing and dyeing traditions in a single visual display.

Words Worth

SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 13, 2026

SRINATH SRIDHARAN

LIAQUAT AHAMED'S GRIPPING history of the first global financial crisis shows how speculation, leverage and human folly can travel from markets into politics, society and the lives of ordinary people. Reading Liaquat Ahamed's *1873* gives one of those strange experiences in which history begins to look less like history and more like a film we have watched before. The railroad mania of the nineteenth century has an unmistakable echo in today's excitement around artificial intelligence. Markets are buoyant, capital is chasing a transformative technology, valuations can run ahead of underlying cash flows, and everyone has a convincing reason why this time is different.

In India, the backdrop is even more layered: demographic transition, the rapid formalisation of finance, high public and private investment, geopolitical fragmentation, supply-chain rewiring, energy transition, climate risk and the possibility that AI will alter jobs and productivity before institutions have understood its consequences. The worry is familiar enough to make the past feel uncomfortably close. *1873* is a story of how financial excess escapes the balance sheet and enters the bloodstream of society.

Ahamed's story begins when the world itself was becoming newly connected. By the end of the 1860s, railways were stitching countries together, capital was crossing borders and governments and entrepreneurs had discovered the bond market as a way of borrowing against the future. America was building railways across a continent. Germany was flush with funds from the French indemnity after the Franco-Prussian War. Vienna was awash with property speculation. British and French bankers were financing projects and sovereign borrowers far beyond their own shores. The world economy had enjoyed two extraordinary decades of growth, trade had expanded dramatically and capital investment had surged.

Then came May 1873. The Vienna Stock Exchange collapsed. In a single day the market lost nearly half its value. The panic travelled to Berlin and, across the Atlantic, to New York, where the failure of Jay Cooke & Co, one of America's most important investment houses, turned anxiety into a banking panic. Railway bonds unravelled, companies failed, investors lost fortunes and construction projects stopped. The new transatlantic cable meant financial fear could cross the ocean at unprecedented speed.

But the most revealing stories are not always in the trading rooms. Ahamed follows the shock into Egypt, where Khedive Ismail had borrowed heavily for canals, railways, palaces and the ambitions of a ruler determined to make Egypt look like a modern European power. Debt eventually became a route to foreign control, culminating in Britain's takeover of Egypt. In the Ottoman Empire, sovereign borrowing and financial weakness produced another kind of humiliation: default eroded fiscal sovereignty and opened the door to greater European influence. In



A file photo of the Vienna Stock Exchange, which crashed on May 9, 1873, setting off a devastating global economic downturn known as the 'Long Depression'

THE BOOK IS A REMINDER THAT FINANCIAL RESILIENCE BEGINS WITH STRONG CAPITAL AND DISCIPLINED LEVERAGE

the extraordinary reach of private finance. Politicians, monarchs, bankers and speculators repeatedly convince themselves that they can control forces that have already begun to outrun them. Ahamed has a gift for making these figures feel alive, with their vanity, intelligence, courage, greed and blind spots.

One description in the book is especially unsettling. Antonio Gallenga, *The Times'* correspondent in Constantinople, wrote in the 1870s of a man who seemed "destitute of all powers of reasoning", incapable of breaking through "the magic circle of his concentrated selfishness" to feel sympathy for another human being. It could have been written yesterday.

Across politics, business and public life, human society has acquired extraordinary material power without necessarily acquiring greater wisdom. Our machines are faster. Our markets are deeper. Our communication is instant. The human capacity for vanity, self-interest and willful blindness remains stubbornly intact.

That is perhaps the hardest lesson of *1873*. The book is a further reminder that financial resilience begins with strong capital and disciplined leverage. History has delivered that warning repeatedly, across countries, markets, financial products and generations, and yet every boom persuades people that old restraints have become obsolete. Still, the temptation to borrow against an imagined future remains remarkably durable. In an interconnected world, who will save individuals and institutions from themselves?

Ahamed's achievement is to make that question difficult to dismiss. 1873 was not merely a year in which a stock exchange fell. It was the moment a new global financial system discovered how quickly confidence could travel, how painfully debt could settle, and how easily distress could become political resentment and social hatred. It left behind deflation, populism, protectionism, anti-semitism and a rearrangement of power that reached from Wall Street to Constantinople, Cairo and the American South. Every serious history of global finance eventually brings us back to prudence and human folly. Ahamed does so with a storyteller's instinct for character and consequence. By the end, the reader has almost been transported into that century: hearing the market panic, watching fortunes disappear, seeing governments improvise and societies search for someone to blame.

And then comes the question that refuses to remain in the nineteenth century. After so many crashes, so much regulation, so much financial sophistication and so much accumulated knowledge, have we really learnt from the past?

Srinath Sridharan is an author, corporate adviser & independent director on corporate boards

THE CRASH that looks familiar

A reminder how financial excess can escape the balance sheet to enter the bloodstream of society

America, economic distress and political fatigue helped weaken reconstruction.

The Rothschilds sit at the centre of this sprawling narrative. Their banking instinct was conservative enough to keep them from many of the excesses that damaged others. Yet when the system broke, their name became useful to people looking for someone to blame. Ahamed shows how financial confusion can acquire a political vocabulary: the complicated mechanics of debt, currencies and speculation become easier to explain through conspiracy. The anger directed at Jewish financiers was one of the darker afterlives of the crisis, showing how quickly economic grievance can mutate into social hatred.

And then there is money itself. This is



1873: The First Great Depression and the Making of the Modern World
Liaquat Ahamed
Penguin Random House
Pp 368, ₹1,499

where *1873* becomes more than a story of a market crash. As major economies moved away from silver and towards gold, the supply of money tightened just when economies were struggling under debt. Prices fell for years. Deflation made debts heavier in real terms, squeezed

farmers and producers, and strengthened the position of creditors. What looked like an arcane argument about gold and silver became a fight over who would carry the burden of adjustment. One reason the bond market matters so much in Ahamed's story is that bonds reveal the price at which the world is willing to finance an ambition. They bring together the borrower's credibility, the investor's risk appetite, the cost of money and the market's collective judgment about the future.

A lesson for Indian financial experts is that its corporate bond trading remains shallow and concentrated. A deeper debt market would give the economy something more valuable than another source of capital: a sharper market-based measure of how the world prices India's risk, growth and ambition.

Ahamed's history becomes particularly alive when it moves between finance and human behaviour. Mark Twain appears as an amused and sceptical observer of the speculative age. Karl Marx watches capitalism's convulsions from another vantage point. Jay Gould represents the ruthless opportunism of the period. The Rothschild family embodies

NAWAID ANJUM

MG VASSANJI DID not begin *The Apparition* knowing that half-human, half-bird creatures would eventually descend upon Delhi. "Initially, I thought I would write a historical novel," says the Toronto-based writer, 76. "I started with medieval history and then it just occurred to me to take it into another direction," he adds. The novel is set in the last years of Alauddin Khilji's rule, in a Delhi plagued by famine, court intrigue, religious persecution and fear. "It was a very chaotic time. People were getting murdered," says Vassanji. "I thought maybe I would imagine a writer or philosopher of that period in his despair, imagining another outcome."

That witness is Amir Hassan al-Shirazi, poet, historian, Sufi, court insider, and narrator of the novel, dedicated to "the children of Gaza, slaughtered as we watched". Alauddin asks him whether his rule has been just and tells him to write honestly, without flattery. Amir is close enough to power to see its cruelties but never fully belongs to it. Vassanji says he is an invented character, only "very superficially" linked to historical figures. "I had to make him up." Amir's Sufi master, Sheikh Sadruddin, is modelled on Nizamuddin Auliya, but "there's no one-to-one correspondence. I needed a Sufi I respected."

While writing, Vassanji became absorbed in medieval Islamic philosophy, mathematics and science. He brings up *Hayy ibn Yaqzan*, Ibn Tufayl's 12th-century Arabic novel about a child raised by a doe in isolation, who comes to understand the physical world through observation and reason. It's close to the questions Vassanji was thinking about: how far reason can take us, and whether knowledge of the material world is enough. "In spite of knowing everything

about the physical world, you still need something more," Vassanji says.

He was also drawn to the Mongols, the Nizari Ismailis, also known as the 'Assassins', and Alamut, the Persian mountain fortress destroyed by the Mongols in the 13th century. Alamut has a personal resonance for Vassanji, who comes from a Khoja Ismaili background and has written about tracing his community's spiritual and historical roots in Gujarat back through its pirs and teachers. From there, his reading led him to Alauddin's violent final years and the rise of his slave-turned general, Malik Kafur.

Another text fascinated him: the animal fables in the *Epistles of the Brethren of Purity*, in which animals make their case against humans before the King of the Jinn. The work sharpened his interest in creation, knowledge and humanity's treatment of animals. "I learned a lot," he says. Yet he is wary of pretending every historical thread must neatly connect. "When you've read enough, then some of the connections come," he says. "And some don't come."

The novel's deepest argument is about assimilation. "When the Mongols came here, the Sultan had started local culture to accommodate," Vassanji says, thinking aloud about how societies change when new people arrive. The British did the same in another form elsewhere. With every encounter comes resistance, adaptation, fear and exchange. "The same anxieties of losing your history, your identity, your culture," he says. "And at the same time assimilating, whether you want to or not."



The Apparition
MG Vassanji
Tranquebar,
Pp 298, ₹799

In his latest novel, MG Vassanji speaks about his East African past, migration and assimilation

Born in Nairobi (Kenya) to Indian immigrants, raised in Tanzania and later settled in Canada after studying in the United States, Vassanji knows that unease intimately. Even Swahili, which he speaks with his wife, has absorbed so much English that the boundaries have

blurred; he regrets not passing more of it to his sons. "That feeling always remains. Basically, I put that into this novel. That loss." He traces this restlessness further back to his Lohana ancestors, generations who moved through western India and then to Kenya, Zanzibar, Colombo and elsewhere. "It's kind of a nomadic existence," he says. "That's my theory."

The pattern continues in his own family; his sons, too, have made lives across countries. "Somehow, for our community, rootedness is harder to accomplish." His 2024 essay collection *Nowhere, Exactly* asks whether home can ever be singular for people formed by several places. Vassanji no longer sounds troubled by not having one answer. "I'm always rooted in a place," he tells me. "But then I find that I feel comfortable in a place only because I know I can always travel." He calls himself "a creature of habit who travels."

Delhi entered that long journey through travel rather than ancestry. Whenever he came to India, Vassanji says, Delhi was usually the first stop. "I would first come here," he says. It became "the key" through which the rest of India's geography began to make sense to him. Gujarat, Shimla, Calcutta and other places branched out from it. That relationship has already produced *A Delhi Obsession*, but the Delhi of *The Apparition* demanded a different imagining an older city whose records can tell a novelist only so much.

Vassanji is working on another novel, now "almost finished". It looks at a generation slightly older than his own, formed by university life, decolonisation and the political idealism of the 1960s and early 1970s, when Tanzania was a frontline state in the struggles against white minority rule in Rhodesia and apartheid South Africa. "That

Toronto-based writer MG Vassanji



awareness was very much part of our growing up," he says.

Vassanji also returns to East African writers he feels have slipped from view, among them Peter Nazareth and Bahadur Tejani, particularly when compared with the attention given to West African writers. Tejani's *Day After Tomorrow* interests him because it tried to imagine a genuinely African-Indian future through an interracial relationship. "There was, of course, among the Indians, Asians, racial resistance," Vassanji says, adding that African communities had their own traditions and boundaries. "There's a relative ignorance, mutual ignorance, between Africans and Asians."

He remembers Tanzania Publishing House and Walter Bgoya, later founder of Mkuki na Nyota. The press is now run by Bgoya's son, Mkulki, and Vassanji has sent him a new collection of stories set entirely in the small part of Dar es Salaam where he grew up. When his regular publisher worried about too many books appearing close together, Vassanji replied, "But I'm not getting younger either." Sending the stories back to Tanzania felt right: "It was like going back... my homage to the place I grew up in."

That return to place loops back neatly to *The Apparition*. The novel is interested not only in conquest, but in what follows: what people surrender without noticing, what they acquire, and when something once foreign becomes ordinary. As Amir's Sufi master comes to understand, Vassanji says, "the world is bigger and, therefore, you have to accommodate what's in there."

"What do you gain and what do you lose when your world, whether you like it or not, opens up?" The question belongs as much to the present as to Vassanji's medieval Delhi. He sees the novel as a response to the anxieties around identity, migration, conquest, globalisation and cultural change. "If you don't travel, the world comes to you," he says. "In this case it is the Avians who come." And when they do, "you have to realise that the world was much bigger".

Nawaid Anjum is a freelancer

ON THE SHELF



IN THE REALM OF THE LAST MAN
Francis Fukuyama
Hachette
Pp 256, ₹699

In this memoir, encompassing his father's involvement in the civil rights movement and his own work on CIA contracts in the 1980s, Francis Fukuyama analyses his life alongside the seismic political shifts of the last 30 years — from Bush to Obama to Trump, from the War on Terror to Russia's Ukraine invasion. Profound and provocative, this is an intimate portrait of one of the 21st century's most important thinkers, an urgent study of contemporary politics — and a treatise on how the West can claw democracy back from the brink.



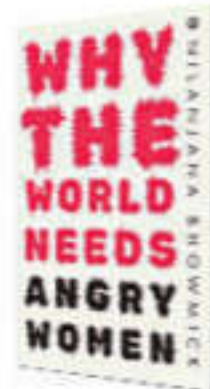
PILL-FREE
Dr Chandrakant Lahariya
Penguin
Random House
Pp 328, ₹499

Dr Chandrakant Lahariya takes on one of the under-discussed health challenges of our time: the culture of unnecessary medicines, supplements, tests and procedures. Packed with patient stories, myth-busting insights, checklists, nutrition guidance, kitchen wisdom and practical tools, this book empowers you to start a fulfilling journey to reduce your pills, reverse diseases and take charge of your metabolic health with confidence.



THE LIFT-OFF NATION
Rajan Anandan & Saurabh Juggernaut
Pp 384, ₹1,099

Once upon a time, India accounted for 25% of global GDP. Two start-up veterans, Saurabh Srivastava, co-founder of NASSCOM, TIE and IAN, and Rajan Anandan, former head of Google, Microsoft and Dell in India and now a managing director at Peak XV Partners, argue that it can do so again by harnessing India's start-ups. With case studies and data points, they give compelling reasons why the time for India's startup ecosystem is now.



WHY THE WORLD NEEDS ANGRY WOMEN
Nilanjana Bhownick
Aleph Book Company
Pp 176, ₹699

Women are angrier than men. This is a statistical finding in India as well as elsewhere in the world. Yet, in a system rigged against them, women have historically not been allowed to claim their anger openly. *Why the World Needs Angry Women* is a seething, blistering manifesto in favour of the modern woman's right to anger. Blending biting humour and philosophical depth, Bhownick shows how women's anger is different from male anger.



WANDERED THE TRAVELLER
Translated by Daisy Rockwell
HarperCollins
Pp 384, ₹699

First published in 1955, *Wandered the Traveller* is a lost classic of south Asian literature — now available in English for the first time in Daisy Rockwell's revelatory translation. Nisar Aziz Butt's semi-autobiographical novel follows Afgar, a brilliant young Pashtun woman, from a turbulent orphaned childhood, through the cloistered world of a mountain sanatorium, to the brink of departure in pursuit of a doctorate at Cambridge.

SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 13, 2026

Fe Lines

STORIES AND TRENDS FROM INDIA AND AROUND THE WORLD THAT CAUGHT OUR FANCY



Performance artiste Zoe Ziegfeld with a snake during Met auditions in New York; Dunston played by Sam, a real orangutan from *Dunston Checks In* (below)

Sit, stay... ACTION

Boas recently auditioned for a Met production, showing animals on stage is serious business

VAISHALI DAR

THE ROAD TO stardom can be a slippery one, quite literally. At New York's Metropolitan Opera, even the snakes have to audition. For its production of Mozart's *Cosi fan tutte*, relocated to a 1950s Coney Island carnival, the Met needed a snake for a memorable stage appearance. Several boas were put through the test by Zoe Ziegfeld, the production's snake handler and a former Coney Island carnival performer. The reptiles were observed slithering, wrapping around their handler and being lifted above her head under simulated stage conditions. But there was only one successful candidate — Princess, a large, striking sun-glow boa constrictor. Her size, colour and calm temperament won her the part. It may sound whimsical, but animal casting is serious business. An animal cannot read a script, hit a mark because a director shouts 'Action!', or be persuaded to repeat a brilliant performance simply because the first take went well. Trainers and filmmakers have to work around an animal's natural

behaviour, and establish whether that particular animal is comfortable enough to work at all.

"Animals have to perform as do human talent," animal supplier Nancy Novograd, who supplied the Met's snakes, explained in a news report. Sometimes an animal has to demonstrate a particular behaviour or its qualification is being able to remain calm around lights, cameras, music and people.

Hollywood has been conducting versions of these auditions for decades. Animal talent agencies match scripts with creatures that have the right breed, appearance, temperament and training. These days, casting may begin with photographs or videos. But animal auditions have sometimes been considerably more literal. In 1961, for instance, Hollywood held what became known as the 'Black Cat Cattle Call' for an Edgar Allan Poe adaptation. Some 152 black cats auditioned for *Tales of Terror*, released in 1962. Cats with white paws or noses were rejected, as were those deemed too friendly. The filmmakers selected animals whose faces looked suitably sinister.

The process becomes more complicated when the animal has to carry a film. The best example is *Dunston Checks In*, the 1996 comedy about an orangutan who causes chaos inside a luxury hotel. The central character, Dunston, was played by Sam, a real orangutan. Rather than teaching him to 'act', trainers built performances around cues, repetition and rewards. For complicated sequences, production teams relied on mats, specialised sets, stunt substitutes and mechanical effects to keep the animal safe and make scenes repeatable.

Babe, the 1995 film about a pig who wants to become a sheepdog, presented a bigger logistical challenge. The production required pigs, dogs, cats, ducks, horses, mice, a cow and hundreds of sheep. According to the *Los Angeles Times*, 58 trainers worked with more than 900 animals. The larger point is that an animal audition is rarely about asking, "Can this creature act?" But asking, "Can this creature safely and reliably do what the scene requires?"

As for the recent film *Sinners*, timber

rattlesnakes were selected through video auditions. Their work came with a level of safety planning, a trained handler, medical support and emergency extraction procedures were required on set.

Dogs have also become some of the most recognisable animal performers in cinema. Bing, the Great Dane in *The Friend*, was selected not merely for his appearance but for his ability to perform specific behaviours and emotional-looking cues. Max, the scruffy dog who played Milo alongside Jim Carrey in *The Mask*, became a memorable comic performer. Uggie, the Jack Russell Terrier from *The Artist*, became so celebrated that he won the Palm Dog Award at Cannes.

Then there is Crystal the Monkey, whose film and television career included *The Hangover Part II* and *Night at the Museum*. She became one of Hollywood's best-known animal performers, proof that an animal does not necessarily need dialogue to steal a scene.

Live theatre creates its own challenges. Opera companies have needed dogs for productions such as *La Bohème*, where the animals must remain composed despite powerful voices, orchestras, stage movement and bright lights. Cats have performed in specialised theatre and variety acts, including the Savitsky Cats, known for elaborate routines involving jumping, climbing and balancing. Even pigs have been trained for stage acts requiring agility, repetition and comic timing. The audition, therefore, is less about obedience than trust. Appearance can matter, too. Princess had the colour and visual presence required for the Met production. But her looks alone would never have secured the role. A beautiful animal that panics under stage lights is not a reliable performer.

There is something strangely democratic about the process. Human actors arrive at auditions with monologues, songs, dance routines and resumes. Animal performers arrive with none of that. They have no understanding of fame, reviews or opening night. But their greatest qualifications may be that they are calm, curious, trainable, and willing to cooperate. Perhaps that is why animal auditions remain so fascinating.

TECH-NOW-LOGY

Warning bells

Emergency alert systems on smartphones are becoming a crucial part of disaster preparedness across the world

SREYA DEB

A SHRILL, SHRIEKING sound emanating from your phone? You better be warned — a tornado, rainstorm or earthquake has probably been registered by the weather department. Emergency alert systems on smartphones are becoming a crucial part of disaster preparedness across the world — a way for governments and public welfare bodies, through mobile networks and phone manufacturers, to warn people about threats ranging from extreme weather incidents to earthquakes and public-safety emergencies.

At the heart of many government warning systems is 'Cell Broadcast', a technology that can send the same message simultaneously to phones in a defined geographic area. Unlike an ordinary SMS, cell-broadcast messages do not require authorities to know recipients' phone numbers and are designed to remain effective even when mobile networks are congested. In India, this technology took a major step forward this year in April. The Department of Telecommunications said its indigenous Cell Broadcast Solution, developed by the Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT) with the National Disaster Management Authority and the Ministry of Home Affairs, has been rolled out nationally. The system supports all kinds of networks — whether it's 2G, 3G, 4G or 5G — and is designed to deliver multi-lingual alerts to mobile users, including people who are roaming.

For Android phones, Google's operating system includes wireless emergency alerts, which can display disaster warnings, threat notifications and, in supported countries, AMBER (America's Missing: Broadcast Emergency Response) alerts. Android also includes emergency SOS, available on the Android 12 and following models. Depending on the device and configuration of it, pressing the power button five times can initiate an emergency call, notify emergency contacts, share location and begin other safety actions. Availability varies by country and handset.

Google's Pixel phones add several safety services through the 'personal safety system'. These include emergency SOS, safety check, crisis alerts, emergency

location service and, on supported models, car crash detection as well. Pixel 4a and later devices, including Fold models, support car crash detection in India and 19 other countries including the USA, UK, France, Belgium, Ireland and Canada, among others.

As for Samsung Galaxy devices, they also provide wireless emergency alerts. Depending on the carrier, users can receive national, extreme and severe threat warnings, AMBER alerts, public-safety messages and test alerts. However, the exact options can differ between carriers, as per Samsung.

Apple's iPhone uses a different but complementary system. Government alerts can provide warnings about imminent threats, extreme weather, public safety and other emergencies, and are generally enabled by default, although the categories and ability to disable them vary by country and network provider.

Apple has also expanded emergency capabilities beyond just the conventional broadcast warnings. Enhanced safety alerts, available in the United States

and Taiwan on iOS 26.2 or later models, can provide additional warnings for natural disasters like earthquake and flood information through mobile data or Wi-Fi. For supported iPhone 14 and newer models, Apple offers emergency SOS via satellite. When cellular and Wi-Fi connections

are unavailable, the phone can connect to satellites to communicate with emergency services, provided the user has a clear view of the sky. Availability remains country-specific — this satellite feature does not work on iPhones bought in Armenia, Belarus, mainland China, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, or Russia.

The expanding and evolving range of emergency alert systems means that the smartphone is increasingly becoming an emergency-information device and is not just restricted to a communications tool. However, users should not assume that every alert service works everywhere. Government infrastructure, carrier support, phone hardware, operating-system version and local regulations all impact availability of the facility. Emergency alerts work best when the technology is supported, enabled and understood before a crisis occurs.

GOOGLE PIXEL ADDS SEVERAL SAFETY SERVICES LIKE EMERGENCY SOS, SAFETY CHECK, CRISIS ALERTS & CAR CRASH DETECTION

A new narrative

How interactive storytelling is now allowing the reader to also be its author

SREYA DEB

IF YOU SPENT your childhood in the 1980s and 1990s, you'd surely recall Choose Your Own Adventure (CYOA), a series of books that turned reading into a game, allowing readers to assume the protagonist's role and make choices determining the plot. The stories (an example being *The Cave of Time* by Edward Packard) are formatted so that, after a few pages of reading, the protagonist faces two or three options, each of which leads to further pages and further options, and so on until they arrive at one of the many story endings. Fast forward to the present times, the same concept is witnessing a resurgence, albeit in an online format. These interactive storytelling platforms are not only letting readers become characters, but also shape relationships and sometimes completely change the ending of a story.

The stories work through branching pas-

sages. A reader reaches a decision, clicks an option and is taken to another part of the story. Some websites also offer further customisation of the story's trajectory, allowing the reader/writer to pick an outcome outside of the options provided.

For writers, CYOA offers something traditional fanfiction cannot: a chance to give readers partial ownership of the narrative. Instead of simply imagining what a character might do, the reader gets to make the decision themselves. This helps to create an intimate and personalised relationship between writer and audience. Fandoms popular in the CYOA world are The Marvel and DC universes, *Harry Potter*, *Worm*, and *Jujutsu Kaisen*, among several others.

One of the biggest spaces for this kind of storytelling is itch.io, an independent platform where writers can upload interactive fiction made with tools such as Twine (an open source online tool for interactive, non-linear storytelling). Twine is important because it is free and designed for creating nonlinear stories without requiring advanced programming knowledge. CYOA is well suited to fandom culture. Popular subjects include fantasy, supernatural fiction, romance, dating stories and established fictional universes where readers have strong emotional connections to characters.

On itch.io, highly rated interactive fiction includes fantasy romance and stories inspired by existing fan communities.

Choice of Games, a video game company which publishes interactive novels for digital platforms, takes a structured approach. Its stories are written using the programming language ChoiceScript and are presented as interactive novels in which readers make decisions that influence

characters, relationships and outcomes. The company's Hosted Games programme has allowed writers to publish their own choice-based stories, helping some titles develop dedicated fandoms of their own. Another option is the CYOA Archive, which is organised around community-created adventures. Readers can browse static, image-based CYOAs or play interactive versions directly in their browsers. CYOA has also



Choice of Games publishes interactive novels for digital platforms

entered established fandoms. Archive of Our Own, popularly known as AO3, is primarily a fanfiction archive rather than a dedicated interactive-fiction platform, but writers have found ways to create branching stories using hyperlinks between chapters or sections. Readers can effectively choose which version of events they want to follow.

Glimmer is a similar platform, allowing at least 100 free pages, or 'turns', with paid options for daily extensions on the limit, if the reader wants. Leaving a comment or a review on the story 'earns' the readers further turns in the story.

The tropes are familiar too: enemies to lovers, found family, reincarnation, self-insert protagonists, magical powers, love triangles and "what if?" alternate universes all work naturally with a format built around personal choice. A reader can decide what their character pursues — romance, friendship, revenge or adventure — and then replay the story to discover another possibility. Fan communities already thrive on discussing characters, relationships, theories and alternate endings.

Interactive stories turn those conversations into participation. Readers compare routes, debate choices, share favourite characters and return to discover outcomes they missed.

Well Being

SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 13, 2026

SREYA DEB

WITH GENERIC AND far cheaper versions of glucagon-like peptide-1 (GLP-1) agonists breaking into the market, health experts anticipate a growing adoption of the weight-loss drugs in the near future. With it, they add, the market for dietary protein products is also set to expand. This is because adequate protein intake is essential during GLP-1 therapy to help prevent lean muscle loss, maintain metabolism, and support steady energy levels amid a loss of appetite.

This also assumes significance in a country like India, where protein intake is already lower than normal. According to experts, the ideal protein intake for a person is 0.8-1 gm per kg of body weight daily, at a minimum. A recent study by the think tank Council for Energy, Environment and Water (CEEW), however, found that the average protein intake of an Indian adult is 55.6 gm.

According to Dr Tarun Mittal, vice-chairperson, laparoscopic and robotic bariatric surgeon, Sir Ganga Ram Hospital, New Delhi, protein supplements in pill or medicine form are very likely to appear in the market in a few years, if not months. "With GLP-1 drugs reducing appetite and meal volume, the supplement market may move beyond bars and shakes to include medicalised protein formats - chewables, compact protein tablets, protein shots, amino-acid sachets, collagen/peptide formulations, and fortified multivitamin-like packs," he says. However, Dr Mittal says that the low dosage in pills may pose an issue. "An adult often needs 60-90 gm protein per day, and this cannot be practically delivered through a few tablets," he says.

Dr Richa Chaturvedi, senior consultant, endocrinology, Indraprastha Apollo Hospital, in New Delhi seconds this. "Protein is required in relatively larger quantities compared to vitamins; so a true 'pill format' may remain limited in its ability to deliver meaningful amounts," she says. Nevertheless, she expects the category to grow. "The category is likely to evolve toward more convenient, portion-controlled formats such as concentrated liquids, gels, or sachets that align with changing consumption patterns and preferences," she adds.

Speaking about the possible cons of protein pills or tablets, Dr Jasjeet Wasir, director, endocrinology and diabetology, at Medanta Medicity, says many patients on these drugs already were under-consuming protein. "Due to their reduced food intake, their protein intake may further go down to precipitously unhealthy levels, despite substantial weight loss," he warns. Experts recommend higher protein intake for people on GLP-1, "typically in the range of 1.0-1.6 gm per kg of body weight per day to help preserve muscle mass during weight loss", as per Dr Wasir.

The Carbamide Forte protein chewable, which can be purchased from Amazon, priced at a little over ₹2,000, contains 12 gm of whey isolate protein per scoop and 18 amino acids. However, pharmaceutical companies like Zydus LifeSciences, Alkem, and Dr Reddy's, all of whom launched their own versions of semaglutide, are currently not looking at launching any such pills or tablets in the near future.

Evolving category

Meanwhile, protein supplements in dietary formulations are already seeing a growing demand on e-commerce platforms. "Sports nutrition on Amazon India has grown 35% YoY, but what's more interesting is how the category is evolving. It's moved from being fitness-focused to becoming a mainstream wellness and nutrition category," says Nishant Raman, director, everyday essentials, Amazon India.

Seshu Kumar Tirumala, chief operating officer of Bigbasket, agrees: "The pro-



PRIORITISING PROTEIN IN GLP-1 THERAPY

Amid an anticipated rise in adoption of weight-loss drugs, will the market for protein products — an essential nutrient to offset the impact on appetite & help prevent muscle loss — also see expansion?

NON-DIETARY PROTEIN SUPPLEMENTS

EAA (ESSENTIAL AMINO ACID) CAPSULES

Very low volume; support muscle protein synthesis without full meal feeling

BCAA (BRANCHED-CHAIN AMINO ACID) CAPSULES

Widely available in India; not a complete protein but can complement intake with minimal volume

UNFLAVOURED WHEY PROTEIN ISOLATE: Can be mixed into small amounts of liquid or food, delivering substantial protein in a compact serving

PROTEIN MICROSHOTS

Small volume liquids (often 30-60 ml) with 15-25 gm protein, common in some Western markets; beginning to appear in the Indian market

CLINICAL AMINO ACID FORMULATIONS

Used in hospital settings for patients who cannot eat normally; prescription only; these are not sold over the counter

with GLP-1-based therapy." Dr Chaturvedi echoes this opinion, saying, "For the overall population, the impact is expected to be gradual and limited in the near term, mainly because access is still evolving."

Doctors say GLP-1 induced appetite suppression can be particularly risky for certain demographics. "Nutritional needs differ across groups," says Dr Chaturvedi. "Older adults, women, and physically active individuals generally have higher or more specific protein requirements, so they may need to be slightly more mindful about maintaining adequate intake as eating patterns change." Dr Wasir elaborates, "Older adults aged 60 years and above have a higher baseline risk of muscle loss and sarcopenia, and a reduced appetite can accelerate declines in strength and function; for women, especially postmenopausal, lower protein and micronutrient intake can worsen osteoporosis and frailty risk; appetite suppression makes it harder to achieve adequate quantity and amino acid balance for vegetarians and vegans; and low income groups who have lesser access to nutrition sources." According to the report by CEEW, Indians from low income groups consume 1.5 times less protein than those in high incomes groups or residing in urban areas.

Supplements in use

Some low-bulk protein supplement products are already available, which do not give the full meal feeling, but that their "availability in India is patchy", as per Dr Wasir. Essential amino acid or EEA tablets are also available. But they are low volume, and support muscle protein synthesis without a full meal feeling. Branched-chain amino acid or BCAA tablets are also there, which are more easily available in India, which again "is not a complete protein but can complement intake with minimal volume."

Meanwhile, protein microshots, which are small volume liquids (often 30-60 ml) with 15-25 gm protein, and common in some Western markets, are beginning to appear in India, Dr Wasir adds.

Dr Chaturvedi adds, "There are already lighter-format options available, such as protein waters, hydrolysed protein supplements, and amino acid-based products which are designed to be less heavy and easier to consume, offering more flexibility."

HEALTH CAPSULES



Mothers' anaemia risk to babies' brains

Over a third of pregnant women globally have anaemia - a condition typically caused by iron deficiency in which the number of red blood cells in the body is lower than normal. On average, the total brain volume of babies born to anaemic mothers was 4% lower than that of babies born to non-anaemic mothers.



Hot drinks may increase cancer risk

Regularly drinking beverages like tea and coffee at very hot temperatures increases the risk of cancer of the food pipe or gullet, known as oesophageal cancer, UK research suggests. Although chances are low, people who had their drinks "very hot" had around a three times higher risk of the cancer than "warm" drinkers.



444 mn Indians at risk from passive smoking

A new study published in *The Lancet Public Health* estimates that 2.71 billion people worldwide were exposed to second-hand smoke in 2023. Deaths attributable to second-hand smoke in India have risen by nearly 50% since 1990. The study estimated that 444 million in India were at risk from passive smoking.



Surgery may improve irregular periods

Researchers found that at 12 and 24 months post-surgery, the average weight loss of women was more than 30 kgs. Post-surgery the number of women who had polycystic ovaries, which is known to affect fertility, was significantly reduced and persisted in only 10% of women with the condition after 24 months.



Dr Rajesh Koppikar

FE FEATURES

MORE THAN DENTAL hygiene, there is increased focus on dental aesthetics and many toothpastes claim whitening powers. Can pastes actually whiten teeth? Dr Rajesh Koppikar, consultant, dental surgery, Kokilaben Dhirubhai Ambani Hospital, Mumbai, says: "Whitening toothpastes do make teeth look brighter, but there is a limit to what they can do. What they are removing is surface staining from things like coffee, tea, tobacco, and certain foods, using mild polishing ingredients that work during regular brushing. Nowadays we also have a purple toothpaste in the market which works as optical brightener and these can instantly colour-correct the yellow tones of teeth. These

White teeth done right

Home remedies, toothpaste or dental cleaning — which works best

toothpastes are gentle enough for everyday use. However, deeper stains which are within the tooth are beyond what these products can reach. Anyone looking for results that go further than that would need to speak to a dentist about peroxide-based options."

Do home remedies work, like salt, baking powder-vinegar etc, and are they safe?

Home remedies for teeth whitening are popular, but not all of them are as harmless as they seem. Baking soda-based toothpaste can do something useful for surface stains, though a proper dental product is always the more reliable choice over anything homemade. Vinegar and acidic ingredients are ones to stay away from, as regular contact with

teeth gradually wears the enamel down. Salt and rough scrubs can cause damage too if someone goes at it too hard. Natural does not automatically mean safe for dental use.

How often is dental cleaning recommended for plaque control?

Most people visit the dentist every six months without giving it much thought, but that interval is not backed by strong evidence as the ideal for everyone. The right frequency really depends on the person, how fast plaque and tartar accumulate, and how prone they are to gum disease. What holds true for just about everyone, regardless of how often they see a dentist, is brushing twice a day and cleaning between teeth to stay on top of plaque.

Is dental cleaning safe for enamel?

Dental cleaning done by a qualified professional is safe, and it does something brushing at home simply cannot, which is removing the hardened tartar that builds up over time. A lot of people worry that scaling wears the enamel down or thins the teeth, but that is not how it works. The instruments used are designed to clear deposits off the surface without damaging it. Some sensitivity after a cleaning session is possible, especially for those who already have gum recession or exposed roots, but it tends to settle.

Is plaque harmful or merely an aesthetic concern?

Plaque is something that forms on teeth constantly, and it is far more than



just a cosmetic concern. The bacteria in that sticky film are what lead to tooth decay and gum trouble over time, causing the kind of redness and bleeding that people often dismiss as normal. When plaque is not cleared away regularly it

hardens into tartar, and at that point brushing is no longer enough to deal with it. That is where the risk of gum disease starts to grow, which is exactly why daily brushing and cleaning between teeth matter as much as they do.

Leisure

SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 13, 2026

ICE CREAM gets its own space...



Much like alcohol, tea or coffee, dedicated outlets for ice creams are changing the way people enjoy the frozen dessert

VAISHALI DAR

FOR DECADES, ICE CREAM in India was picked up from a neighbourhood freezer, consumed on the way home or ordered alongside a meal. Today, that habit is changing. More people are choosing where to have it, what flavour to try and how much of an experience they want around the scoop as they sit and relax in the neighbourhood 'ice cream bar'.

Such ice cream bars, along with artisanal gelaterias and destination-led parlours, are turning an impulse-driven category into an experience. The evolution is visible across the segment, from established names to newer concepts.

Jaatre, for instance, integrates the dessert into an outlet-cum-restaurant experience. The ice-cream brand, which claims to be homemade and 100% vegan, is served at Carnatic Cafe outlets across Delhi-NCR. As a separate stand-alone setup in addition to being served inside Carnatic Cafe, Jaatre revolves around the 'farm-to-scoop' concept, with its products served in upcycled, scraped coconut shells with wooden spoons, while larger take-home orders are packed in biodegradable terracotta tubs that help naturally retain the cold temperature.

At the premium end, Scoop Room is attempting to portray ice cream in a new light. "We've become curious consumers in almost every category," says founder Pallavi Gupta, adding: "People want to understand how their coffee is roasted or how chocolate is sourced. But very few people have ever been encouraged to think about ice cream in the same way."

Opened in Bengaluru's Indiranagar in August, with plans for two more outlets this year and a pan-India expansion by 2028, Scoop Room has 24 flavours, such as cookie dough hour, paan-tastic, pick

me avo and nutty basil. Its waffle cones and sauces are made in-house.

That curiosity is also reshaping what consumers expect from an ice cream outlet. Scoop Room is designed as a youthful neighbourhood destination with accents of neon green, pink, yellow and silver, while vintage telephones and dedicated scoop corners are part of the physical space. It also features a pet-friendly outdoor area, encouraging people to enjoy a scoop with family and friends.

Flavours & formats

At Zimero, Chef De Cuisine Sumant Bhargava identifies three trends shaping India's new ice-cream bars: bold flavours and formats, cleaner ingredients, and the way the product is served.

"Indian consumers are seeking experiences over products," says Bhargava, adding: "Whether it's flavours or formats like cake slices, cookies and gelatos, consumers want something different. Then there are clean ingredients like real chocolate, no added colours or flavours, and finally, how the ice cream is served. Cones, cookie cones, bubble cones, toppings, even gold leaf, anything that gives joy."

Zimero's offerings reflect that appetite for experimentation. With stores in Connaught Place and Gurugram, and 22 dark stores across Delhi-NCR and other key cities, the brand offers formats including sundaes, cakes and cookie cones, alongside flavours such as wild cherry, goat cheese and blueberry, south Indian filter coffee and dark

chocolate pistachio. Sugar-free and lower-calorie options are gaining traction too, although Bhargava sees them as serving a different need from the indulgent ice cream bar experience.

"Q-commerce is growing exponentially and addresses impulse and low-value consumption. Ice cream bars, on the other hand, offer experience and significantly premium products," he says.

Ice cream bars are not confined to emerging premium brands. Large established players are also expanding the role of the physical outlet. Naturals Ice Cream, the homegrown brand, started with one store in Juhu in 1984 and has today grown to 170 outlets across the country. While classics like sitaphal, tender coconut and alphonso mango continue to be customer favourites, the brand has

also been experimenting with newer formats through Naturals NOW, its experiential offshoot launched in 2019. It serves not only their speciality scoops of natural ice cream flavours but also sundaes and milkshakes, including freshly churned daily flavours such as tadgola (ice apple) and sitaphal sundaes, mudslide, baklava sundaes, premium shakes and more.

Meanwhile, Baskin-Robbins India says consumers increasingly want to spend time with the product rather than simply take it away. "It's no longer just about a quick takeaway, but an experience they want to sit back and savour," says Mohit Khattar, CEO, Graviss Foods, the master franchisee for Baskin-Robbins in India. The company operates more than 1,100 standalone parlours across over 300 cities in India and the SAARC region, and adds around 100-120 stores annually. Its parlours are becoming broader dessert destinations, extending beyond its signature 31 flavours to sundaes, shakes, cheesecakes, brownies, muffins, ice cream cakes and seasonal specials.

Immersive engagement

Specialist players see potential in the dedicated premium ice cream format. "Ice cream in India is moving beyond being an impulse purchase or a seasonal dessert. Consumers are looking for experiential food formats, and exclusive ice cream outlets are creating an opportunity for brands to engage with consumers in a much more immersive way," says Suhas B Shetty, founder and CEO of Iceberg Organic Ice Creams, which currently has nine outlets across Hyderabad, Bengaluru and Vijayawada.

Shetty says the company plans to add six stores in south India by the end of the current financial year, while entering q-comm and modern trade. It also plans to take the brand beyond south India into Mumbai, Delhi and Pune soon.

Meanwhile, Walko Food Company, which operates NIC Ice Creams, Grameen Kulfi and Mimo Ice Creams, and manages popular frozen dessert and ice cream brands across India, is continuously scaling its retail. It has expanded into over 21 stores and a few to be launched soon. Shamika Erande, AGM, marketing, Walko Food Company, says, "Since parlours are a capex investment heavy channel, with investments depending on the size, location and operation type like a standalone parlour or experience centre, we are looking to expand our reach in tier 1-2 cities and highway mall locations which have high traffic of audience with disposable income looking for upgraded lifestyle experiences. We also plan to expand the premium brand's positioning (NIC Honestly Crafted Ice Creams) and attract innovative ice cream (with Mimo Ice Creams) to a more accessible, wider and value seeking consumer base."



A COOL RECORD

In Chennai, 4,008 students got together in January to break the record for the 'longest chain of people licking ice cream'. Participants had to consume ice cream continuously for 1 minute while holding hands and offering ice cream to the person on their right



(Above) Artiste uses honey and jaggery in place of refined sugar; (bottom) Yura Artisanal Scoops brings a distinctly chef-led approach to frozen desserts

... With a premium, artisanal touch

Take your pick from handcrafted gelatos to seasonal fruit scoops and vegan sorbets

SREYA DEB

NOT TOO LONG AGO, choosing an ice cream just meant deciding between flavours, whether it's vanilla, chocolate, strawberry or butterscotch. Today, dessert lovers are spoilt for choice, with options ranging from small-batch gelatos to seasonal fruit scoops, vegan sorbets to sugar-free indulgences, proving that ice creams can be as much about innovation as they are about indulgence.

Catering to this demand is a slew of brands that are turning artisanal ice creams into one of the most exciting segments of India's food landscape. At ITC Grand Chola, Chennai, for instance, Yura Artisanal Scoops brings a distinctly chef-led approach to frozen desserts. Inspired by European techniques while incorporating Indian ingredients, Yura focuses on handcrafted gelatos and ice creams with sophisticated flavour profiles, premium ingredients, and innovative presentation. The products reflect the growing crossover between fine dining and artisanal desserts, with flavours such as filter coffee sundae and aam papad gelato, and tres leches and tiramisu flavoured melted ice cream dishes on offer.

Shaarik Akhtar, GM, ITC Grand Chola, says the concept attracted guests across age groups and nationalities. "Several guests who are world travellers have mentioned that our offerings at Yura beat international quality," he says.

Shmoozies is another brand that's combining premium ingredients with imaginative flavours and visually appealing creations. It caters to younger consumers seeking desserts that are as Instagram-worthy as they are delicious. Located in Chennai, Shmoozies offers seasonal flavours including avocado and lime, mango cheesecake, chilli guava, sitaphal and

strawberry zapota, among others, offering ice cream sorbets, ice cream crumble pies, ice cream tacos, and cakes, along with its regular offering of popsicles and scoops.

"Chennai has a fairly vibrant dessert culture," says Gauri, product manager at Shmoozies' main outlet in Anna Nagar, adding: "People are open to newer establishments, more so than before. Many stores have been around for years. The only difference is that the range of flavours is steadily expanding now as well."

According to the product manager, while earlier the most 'artisanal' item on ice cream parlour menus used to be items like banana split, now the offerings are far more innovative and varied.

Meanwhile, artisanal ice cream brands are also focusing on all-natural ingredients. Artiste Handcrafted Ice Cream, a handcrafted ice cream brand, for instance, uses honey and jaggery in place of refined sugar in several recipes, while offering flavours such as mango avocado, banana caramel with chia seeds, coconut malai, and tulsiginger. Its founder Madhvi Parikh says consumers' interest has grown significantly. "Today's consumers want their ice cream to be delicious and indulgent, while also being conscious of health, ingredients, and quality. They increasingly ask, 'What exactly am I eating?'"—seeking the perfect balance of great taste and ingredients they can trust," she adds.

Many artisanal ice cream brands are making themselves available on quick commerce platforms as well. Health-conscious consumers are embracing Mumbai-based Go Zero, whose zero-added-sugar ice creams have emerged as a favourite among fitness enthusiasts and families alike. Ahmedabad's Hocco combines traditional recipes with modern branding and nationwide expansion, and the company is helping bridge the gap between artisanal quality and large-scale accessibility.

EARLIER, THE MOST 'ARTISANAL' ITEM USED TO BE THE BANANA SPLIT. THE OFFERINGS ARE NOW FAR MORE VARIED



SCREEN TIME | Your entertainment bucket list for this week



STRANGER THINGS
Netflix
Releases: **September 17**

STRANGER THINGS: Tales From '85 returns for a second animated adventure in Hawkins, where Valentine's Day brings more than romance. Ghostly apparitions and a destructive swarm of hate sprites begin terrorising the seemingly quiet town, drawing the Hawkins Investigators Club into another supernatural mystery. Eleven, Mike, Dustin, Lucas, Will, Max and their friends must uncover who — or what — is behind the disturbances before a new gate to the Upside Down tears open.



DAAYRA
Theatres
Releases: **September 18**

INSPIRED BY TRUE EVENTS, *Daayra* follows DCP Raman Kumar (Prithviraj Sukumaran) and DCP Ajooni Kohli (Kareena Kapoor Khan), two police officers divided by a disturbing criminal case. When Raman's pursuit of swift justice culminates in a controversial encounter, Ajooni begins investigating his actions and the public narrative surrounding them. Their confrontation exposes the uneasy line between law and vigilantism, while raising questions about accountability, due process and collective outrage.



LUST STORIES 3
Netflix
Releases: **September 18**

RETURNING FOR A THIRD instalment, *Lust Stories 3* brings together four intimate tales about love, longing, repressed desire and the messy realities of modern relationships. Directors Vikramaditya Motwane, Kiran Rao, Shakun Batra and Vishal Bhardwaj create distinct cinematic worlds in which attraction collides with vulnerability, silence and unexpected choices. The anthology features Radhika Apte, Konkona Sen Sharma, Aditi Rao Hydari, Radhika Madan, Sana Thampi, Siddharth, Ali Fazal, Vijay Varma, Abhishek Banerjee and Gurfateh Pirzada.



LOVE LOTTERY
Theatres
Releases: **September 18**

LOVE LOTTERY FOLLOWS corporate professional Kartik Saxena (Akshay Oberoi), whose troubled marriage becomes the centre of a murder investigation when his wife, Bharani Verma (Heli Daruwala), is found dead under mysterious circumstances. Arrested as the prime suspect, Kartik insists he is innocent and enters a courtroom battle to clear his name. As witnesses take the stand, conflicting statements, concealed relationships and long-buried secrets turn an apparently straightforward case into a maze of suspicion.



RESIDENT EVIL
Theatres
Releases: **September 18**

RESIDENT EVIL REINVENTS Capcom's survival-horror franchise through an original story unfolding amid the Raccoon City outbreak. Bryan (Austin Abrams), a medical courier, is sent to make a delivery at Raccoon City General Hospital when a deadly infection turns a night into a relentless fight for survival. Trapped as chaos spreads and monstrous creatures close in, he must navigate the city with limited resources and no easy escape.

— COMPILED BY MITALI

Opinion

SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 13, 2026

MEASUREMENT OF GDP, ESPECIALLY THE RATE OF GROWTH OF GDP, IS CRUCIAL TO GAUGE THE HEALTH OF THE ECONOMY

Holding a mirror to GDP numbers

ACROSS THE AISLE

P Chidambaram



AS SOMEONE SAID, tongue in cheek, people don't eat GDP numbers. People eat food, wear clothes and footwear, send their children to school, buy medicines, use mobile phones, watch television, scroll social media, and want to be safe and happy — measured as Consumption. The aggregate of *Consumption (C)*, *Investment (I)*, *Government spending (G)* and *net Exports (X - M)* — after factoring for taxes and subsidies— is Gross Domestic Product (GDP). Measurement of GDP, especially the *rate of growth* of GDP, is crucial to gauge the health of the economy.

Healthier debate

The MoSPI has released the GDP numbers for Q1 of 2026-27: the rate of growth is 10.3% in nominal (current) prices and 7.8% in constant prices compared to Q1 2025-26. The government and the *sarkari* economists are pleased. The sceptics have raised questions. There is a raging debate on the credibility of the GDP numbers. Rather

	OLD BASE YEAR (2011-12) GDP		New base year (2022-23) GDP	
	Nominal Real		Nominal Real	
	Current prices	Constant prices	Current prices	Constant prices
2022-23	268.90	161.65	261.77	261.77
2023-24	301.23	176.51	290.73	280.94
2024-25	330.68	187.97	317.99	301.15
2025-26	357.14	201.90	345.37	324.70
CAGR	9.92%	7.69%	9.68%	7.45%
GDP in Q1 of 2026-27			88.26	81.36
Growth over Q1 of 2025-26			10.33%	7.82%

GDP IN ₹ LAKH CRORE

than debating the desirability of 'one nation, one election' (which will undermine federal parliamentary democracy), it is better to debate the GDP numbers and whether the benefits of growth are percolating to the people. I do not wish to add to the noise. Let's assume that MoSPI's numbers are correct. My calculations of the compounded annual growth rate (CAGR) of nominal and real GDP on two different base years are (*see Table*): Notably, on the old base year and the new base year, the CAGR beginning 2022-23 is *more or less the same*. The growth rate in Q1 of 2026-27 is only margin-



ally higher. Conclusion: the economy has *not* shifted gears in 2026-27; nor is it in overdrive. Therefore, no boast is warranted.

Pertinent questions

Let's hold a mirror to the latest GDP numbers. The nagging question is, under the old base year, the GDP in constant prices is very depressed compared to the GDP in current prices but it is not so under the new base year. Why? Be that as it may, the growth rate ought to

be reflected in the measurable parameters of the economy such as jobs, wages, consumption, trade, investment, etc. Here are some pertinent questions:

■ Why is the unemployment rate among youth of 15-29 years at a high of 16.2%? CMIE has reported that the unemployment rate for graduates aged 29-34 years often touches 40-45%; why? According to NITI Aayog, 8.7 crore youth aged 15-29 are 'Not in Employment, Education or Training' (NEET); why?

■ Why are *real* wages growing at dismal rates of (-) 5.5, 1.7 and 3.3%, respectively, among casual, salaried and self-employed workers? (*source: PLFS*). Twenty per cent of the workforce is casual labour and will they not be further impoverished by the negative wage growth?

■ Why is *net* FDI so low? FCNR (B) mobilisation which carried interest rates of 6-7% came in truckloads, but why is foreign capital not coming as direct investment?

■ When forex reserves have touched an all-time high of \$740 billion, why has the rupee not appreciated? Since January 2026, the rupee has depreciated nearly 5% against the US dollar and is reportedly the worst performing Asian currency; why?

■ Exports are rising, but imports are rising too. At current prices, imports are rising faster. Merchandise trade deficit touched \$150 billion in April-August 2026. The trade deficit with China alone in April-July was \$44 billion. Is the trade deficit not a drag on the economy? Why are Make-in-India, PLI, ASPIRE, NMCP and other schemes not resulting in manufacture of the goods that India imports from China?

■ In the sectoral composition of nominal GVA, why is 'manufacturing' stagnant at 13%? In fact, the share of the secondary sector in nominal GVA, over many quarters, has been bound

between 24 and 26%. Why have the schemes not pushed up the needle?

■ Why is capital investment, as measured by Gross Fixed Capital Formation (GFCF), stuck at roughly 33.5% of GDP? Of this, *private* corporate capital expenditure has remained unchanged at about 12%. Despite cajolery, admonishments and threats, why are corporate investors not willing to make capital investment?

■ Why has the growth number not resulted in more public goods such as better schools, better hospitals, better roads, better water supply, better policing, etc.? If one takes a straw poll, the overwhelming proportion of citizens will give a thumbs down on each of these areas.

Unedifying mirror image

There is no surprise that Gen Z is protesting against the marked deterioration all around them. We may be growing at 7.8% *statistically*, but most citizens do not *feel or believe* so. Because they know that their lives are not better or easier.

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Putting India on the golf tourism map

FAIRWAY FILES

Rahil Gangjee



THERE IS SOMETHING wonderfully strange about golfers. We will happily travel 3,000 kilometres to play a course we have never seen, spend a small fortune on a hotel, eat whatever is put in front of us, wake up at an ungodly hour and then spend four hours walking around looking for a little white ball that we ourselves hit into trouble. And at the end of it all, we will say, "What a fantastic holiday!"

That, in a nutshell, is golf tourism. For a golfer, a holiday is rarely just a holiday. Give us a decent golf course, good weather, a comfortable bed and something interesting to eat afterwards and we are sold. Add a beautiful landscape and a little history and culture, and you might have to physically drag us home. India has all of these things. What it hasn't always had is the confidence to sell itself as a golfing destination. That could be changing.

The Ministry of Tourism has once again identified golf tourism as an important niche segment, while the Indian Golf Premier League has announced an ambitious plan to mobilise \$2 billion towards golf-tourism infrastructure. The idea is to combine golf with hospitality, travel, MICE and destination development and, importantly, take the game beyond the traditional big-city markets. And honestly, it makes sense. India is almost tailor-made for golf tourism. We have mountains, beaches, deserts, forests, heritage cities and enough different cuisines to keep a golfer happy for several lifetimes. More importantly, we have golf courses in some extraordinary locations.

Take Kashmir. I have always felt that if you could combine golf and scenery, somebody forgot to tell the rest of the world about Srinagar. Royal Springs, with the mountains as a backdrop, is the sort of place where you can spend more time looking around than looking at your scorecard. Gulmarg and Pahalgam offer an entirely different experience. You could quite easily build a golf holiday around the Valley and have a story to tell when you return home.

Then there is Bengaluru. The city has quietly become an important golf destination, with courses such as the Karnataka Golf Association and the newer resort-style facilities around the city. And the great thing about Bengaluru is that you can play golf in the morning, have lunch, attend a meeting, complain about the traffic and still somehow convince yourself you had a relaxing day.

That is a skill only Bengaluru can teach you. Goa is another obvious opportunity. Most people think beaches, nightlife and seafood when they hear Goa. Golfers think, "Where is the nearest tee?" Imagine packaging golf with a few days by the beach, some good food and a little sightseeing. The non-golfer in the family gets a holiday and the golfer gets his rounds. Every- one wins.

That last part is important because golf tourism is not just about golfers. The golfer may travel for the course, but the family travels for everything else. That means hotels, restaurants, transport, sightseeing, shopping, wellness and entertainment all become part of the package. A golf holiday can therefore generate much more economic activity than simply collecting a green fee. And golfers are particularly attractive tourists because we tend to stay longer. We don't fly across the world to play nine holes and catch the next flight home.



Gulmarg and Pahalgam offer an entirely different experience. You could easily build a golf holiday around the valley and have a story to tell when you return home

If we are travelling with three or four clubs and a pair of shoes that cost more than our first car, we are going to make the trip worthwhile.

There is another big opportunity here: tournaments. I have played enough professional golf to know that a tournament can change the personality of a place. During an event, hotels fill up, restaurants get busy, taxis have more passengers and suddenly people who normally wouldn't know a three-wood from a rail- way sleeper are discussing golf. India already has professional tournaments that can become tourism products in their own right. Why should a golf tournament only be marketed to golf fans? Package it with local experiences and suddenly you have a destination event.

The same thinking can work with amateur events, corporate golf and international golf groups. Bring 50 or 100 golfers into a city, give them three or four courses to play, throw in some sightseeing and food, and you have created a small travelling economy.

The biggest challenge, of course, is infrastructure and consistency. Golfers are a demanding lot. We will forgive a bad lie. We will forgive a bad score. We will even forgive our playing partner for giving us unsolicited swing advice. But we will not forgive a golf course that promises one thing and delivers another.

Course maintenance, caddies, transport, booking systems, accommodation and accessibility all matter. International golfers need to know what they are getting before they board a flight. A beautiful photograph on Instagram is not enough when you are standing on the first tee with a trolley, 18 holes ahead of you and a handicap to protect.

India also needs better golf-tourism circuits. Instead of selling one golf course, sell an experience. Delhi-Jaipur. Bengaluru-Mysuru. Goa. Kashmir. Pune and the western Maharashtra circuit. Rajasthan. Even newer destinations can be built around golf if the infra-

structure is planned properly.

And this is where I think the next few years could get really interesting.

India doesn't have to copy Scotland, Spain or Thailand. We don't need to become somebody else's golf destination. We can create our own version.

Imagine a week where you play three or four very different courses, eat incredible food, see a bit of India, stay in good hotels and finish the trip with a tournament or a friendly game. And if your score is terrible, nobody needs to know. You can always blame the jet lag.

The game takes you places. Sometimes literally. I've played golf in enough parts of the world to know that some of my best memories have had very little to do with my score. They have been about the people, the food, the scenery,

the ridiculous bets, the stories afterwards and occasionally the miracle of making a birdie when you had absolutely no business doing so.

India has millions of stories waiting to be attached to golf. We just need to start telling them.

And perhaps, for once, we should stop worrying about whether India can become a golf-tourism destination and start asking a more interesting question:

Why shouldn't it?

After all, we already have the courses, the culture, the food, the scenery and, most importantly, enough golfers who are willing to travel anywhere in the world just to lose a few balls in a different postcode.

Rahil Gangjee is a professional golfer, sharing through this column what life on a golf course is like

Golfers are a demanding lot. We will forgive a bad lie. We will forgive a bad score. But we will not forgive a golf course that promises one thing and delivers another

Who are the real patriots?

FIFTH COLUMN

TAVLEEN SINGH



THERE APPEARS TO be a fifth columnist in the Prime Minister's inner circle. This thought came to me when I saw him jubilantly striding across that college stage in Vadodra last week. The event seemed part of his Gen-Z seduction crusade, and what he strode, smiled and waved to was the tune of *We Will Rock You*. Luckily, it was only the tune that played. Had he been aware of the words, Modi may have fainted. Here is a line: 'You got mud on your face, big disgrace. Somebody better put you back into your place.'

See what I mean about a fifth columnist working in the innards of the PMO? Also, the song is from 1977 when people of my generation were young and rebellious, and the cockroaches who have now got so badly under Modi's skin were not even specks on the horizon. More seriously — who was the idiot who advised the Prime Minister to attend this joyous event at a time when a PG (paying guest) hostel had just crumbled in Delhi University's south campus, killing young students and their dreams? Among the dead was eighteen-year-old Arpit Jai, whose taxi driver father worked overtime to send his son to college and struggled to pay the exorbitant rent for his PG hovel. I heard Arpit's story in Barkha Dutt's *Mojo Story*. It brought tears to my eyes.

We in the mainstream media have mostly ignored the stories of the seven dead students. Perhaps because they would all be as heartbreaking. Instead, almost every news channel reported every moment of the Prime Minister's trip to Gujarat as if it was the most important news of the day. If they had stayed with the building collapse in Satya Niketan, there may have been some hope of coercing the 'triple-engine' government in Delhi to stem the corruption that led to the horror of students being killed for just trying to get a college degree.

While the Chief Minister's cohort surveyed the debris of the illegally built PG (paying guest) hostel from high above, a handful of real journalists dug deeper into the crashed building and showed pictures of the horrendous conditions in which students live. The Cockroach Janta Party leader who said that students are being forced to live like cockroaches is correct. The building that crumbled is among others in which students live in cells built one upon the other, and that can only be reached through dangerously narrow alleys darkened by clumps of hanging wires. I must here add that the best reporting I saw came from a digital

platform called PEEKTV.

When I saw their pictures of those dismal alleyways and dreary rooms, I found myself hoping that the Prime Minister was also watching so he could understand why he needs to forget about our 'demographic dividend'. Young students who are forced to live and study in such horrible conditions will never learn to think, dream or learn. How will they be able to compete with students who, in other colleges in other countries, have already learned how to deal with the technological revolution that AI brings?

This one building collapse has brought to the surface many other things, like the abysmal state of governance in Delhi. It has revealed corruption so evil that it boggles the mind. Everyone is involved in creating the smokescreen that allows builders to disobey the rules of safe planning. The PG mafia that extorts inexplicably high rents from desperate students is controlled by politicians and high officials who always seem to get away with their evil deeds.

The only thing that happens after every disaster of the kind we saw in Satya Niketan is that some lowly officials get publicly yelled at by higher officials like the Chief Minister and then some committee is appointed to (supposedly) go into causes and solutions. These committees never amount to much, as we can see from the one appointed after the building collapse in Delhi's Malviya Nagar some months ago. Corrupt officials and politicians collude to make Delhi non-functional except when there is a big conference of the BRICS kind. And then things only appear to work because visiting dignitaries are only allowed to see restricted sections of India's capital city.

This is the way things are. It is the way things have always been. But the cockroaches and their young cheerleaders are ensuring this is not how they will always be in the future. It is the one thing that gives me some hope that a day will come when officials and politicians who have created the mess that we see today pay for their crimes. One idea from me is that the officials who allowed that PG hostel to be built should be charged with manslaughter, and that this be done every time a building collapses and kills people. No more committees. No more inquiry commissions. When people die because of the criminal negligence of officials, those officials should be charged with manslaughter, if not murder. Meanwhile, the Prime Minister needs to find out who the fifth columnist is in his inner circle and punish him for sending him off to college events where he blames what is wrong with India on 'dimagi naxals'. He seems quite proud of this new label, without noticing that the people he is charging with sedition could be the very patriots that we need today.

Mind & Games

SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 13, 2026

In Bengaluru, a startup, String Bio, is converting one of the world's most potent greenhouse gases into usable products such as food, feed and sustainable materials

SONAM RAINA

IN INDIA AND around the world, methane is leaking into the atmosphere from rice paddies, cattle farms and decomposing waste, accelerating global warming.

While carbon dioxide is the most talked-about greenhouse gas, methane is significantly more potent. To understand why, imagine greenhouse gases as blankets covering the Earth. Carbon dioxide adds many thin blankets, while methane adds only a few but much thicker ones. Even in small amounts, methane traps far more heat. Despite being less abundant in the atmosphere, methane has caused nearly one-third of all warming since the Industrial Revolution. But what if this climate offender could become a resource? That's the question driving String Bio, a Bengaluru-based startup co-founded by Ezhil Subbian and Vinod ML Kumar, which is turning methane into food, feed and sustainable materials.

Transforming a climate change beast into a resource

"When we started String Bio in 2012, our goal was simple but ambitious: how can we take one of the most harmful greenhouse gases, methane, and turn it into something useful and valuable?" says Ezhil Subbian, co-founder of String Bio. "If we could transform this problem into a resource, we would not only address climate change but also build sustainable alternatives for food, agriculture, materials, and other markets."

The process is grounded in microbial science. "What we do is capture methane and feed it to tiny microbes, much like you feed flour to yeast when baking bread," Subbian explains. "The methane is collected and cleaned. It goes into a tank that looks very much like what you would see in a brewery. Inside, our microbes eat the methane and grow. As they grow, they make useful things like nutrients for plants and protein for animals. We then harvest and process these into finished products that different industries can use." These microbes, or methanotrophs, consume methane as their energy source. After 12 years of development, String Bio now produces a gamut of products – a range of bio-nutrients designed to sup-



Is this the world's unlikeliest PROTEIN SOURCE?

port crop yield and soil health and protein ingredients for animal feed.

The journey has not been straightforward. "The first few years were largely focused on high-risk innovation in gas fermentation and at each phase it has been a fun and exciting learning journey," Subbian recalls.

"There were plenty of downs, but the few ups really made it worthwhile." She identifies several pivotal moments from this journey - building a strong team, scaling manufacturing, commercialising products, and establishing partnerships with global companies.

The challenges

Despite the promise, the road to commercialisation is steep. "The single-cell protein market is growing," says Pratyosh Shukla of the School of Biotechnol-

ogy at Banaras Hindu University. "Converting methane to single-cell protein (SCP) and sustainable feed protein is very promising in the upcoming five to 10 years. We need more focus on making it viable and acceptable, including quality control and commercialisation."

"Ensuring the SCP meets protein quality standards and is free from contaminants or endotoxins is critical for feed or food applications," notes Monali Rahalkar, senior scientist at the Agharkar Research Institute in Pune.

Shukla, too, emphasises that full screening as per FSSAI standards is mandatory before such products can be considered for wider use.

Voices from the field

StringBio's agricultural products CleanRise and PRO-DG have been tested

by farmers and partners across India and internationally. You can see documented farmer experiences on its YouTube channel, where Indian farmers describe improvements in crop health, yields and soil condition. "Many have shared that they see healthier crops, better yields and improved soil health after using our products," Subbian notes.

Pathways and barriers

Shukla emphasises the need for economic proof. In India, the most compelling evidence would be field-level economic modelling comparing SCP production with traditional protein sources like soy or fishmeal, along with pilot successes using locally isolated methanotroph strains. "If any industry is funding it, more opportunities are towards commercialisation," he says.

From a policy perspective, Subbian calls for incentives across the value chain and the global harmonisation of regulations around sustainable agricultural inputs. "Today, the rules vary widely across regions, which slows down innovation and market entry," she says.

"Clear, consistent standards would allow solutions like ours to move more quickly across borders."

Why we must apply emergency breaks on methane

The climate solutions non-profit Project Drawdown counts curbing methane emissions among the high-impact climate solutions the world needs right now to stay on a below 2 degrees global heating trajectory. About 40% of existing methane comes from natural

sources, while the remaining 60% is linked to human activities, known as anthropogenic emissions. Most of India's methane comes from sources like livestock, followed by rice fields and waste that decomposes without oxygen, and leaks from fossil fuel activities.

Methane reduction has also become a focus of international climate cooperation. Launched at COP26, the Global Methane Pledge asks countries to cut methane emissions by 30% by 2030, but India did not sign it, citing concerns that binding methane targets could harm its agriculture-dependent economy and interfere with trade rules.

Although not a signatory, India has put in place several methane reduction and management initiatives. Under the National Mission on Sustainable Agriculture, it is promoting climate-resilient rice cultivation practices that lower methane emissions, and through the National Innovations in Climate Resilient Agriculture (NICRA) project, it supports techniques such as direct-seeded rice and crop diversification to reduce methane from rice fields.

The National Livestock Mission comprises measures like balanced animal feeding and fodder improvements to cut methane from livestock. Schemes such as Gobar-Dhan and the New National Biogas and Organic Manure Programme incentivise cattle waste utilisation for biogas and organic manure production, helping capture methane that would otherwise be lost to the atmosphere.

All of this makes String Bio's work pivotal. When asked how the adoption of StringBio's products at scale would practically change agriculture and related value chains, Subbian explains, "At scale, the impact could be transformative. Agriculture is one of the largest contributors to methane and nitrous oxide emissions, and our solutions are designed to directly address these challenges."

Even with just 5% market penetration, our rice solution alone could offset around 30 million tonnes of carbon emissions annually. Practically, this means farmers can improve productivity and soil health while contributing to meaningful reductions in greenhouse gases. Over the next decade, this kind of scale would position agriculture not just as a source of food but also as a central part of the climate solution." That 30-million-tonne figure is rather substantial. Think of it as taking several million cars off the road for a year.

When asked about the next tangible milestone, Subbian is focused on the immediate, which is "Seeing more of String products in commercial use will be the next tangible milestone for us."

In a country that produces significant methane from its agricultural backbone but hesitates to sign international reduction pledges, String Bio's products show a way to address the climate problem while potentially strengthening, rather than constraining, agricultural productivity.

The piece is published in arrangement with Climate Action Live <https://www.climateaction.live>

CROSSWORD

1 Across: Most commonly used fuel by commercial vehicles and cargo haulers (6)

2 Across: Critical Path Analysis, abbr. (3)

3 Across: What to spend in Tehran (4)

4 Across: "R" in TRAI (10)

5 Across: Thin strip of wood (4)

6 Across: Big name in Japanese auto industry (6)

7 Across: Most of the time; in most cases (8)

8 Across: Information about recent and important events (7)

9 Across: Adepts, professionals in their fields (7)

10 Across: An organ or part conveying nervous impulses - "fern feet" anagram? (8)

11 Across: Slightly; to more extent or certainly? (6)

12 Down: Plan your holidays with ___ Mahindra (4)

13 Down: Fertilisers Ltd.: COFE, in short (10)

14 Down: Something to paint red in celebrations (4)

15 Down: ___ tracking: research method to determine what part of the advertisement a consumer looks at (3)

16 Down: Information about recent and important events (7)

17 Down: Adepts, professionals in their fields (7)

18 Down: An organ or part conveying nervous impulses - "fern feet" anagram? (8)

19 Down: Slightly; to more extent or certainly? (6)

20 Down: ___ Mahindra (4)

21 Down: Fertilisers Ltd.: COFE, in short (10)

22 Down: Something to paint red in celebrations (4)

23 Down: ___ tracking: research method to determine what part of the advertisement a consumer looks at (3)

24 Down: Information about recent and important events (7)

25 Down: Adepts, professionals in their fields (7)

26 Down: An organ or part conveying nervous impulses - "fern feet" anagram? (8)

27 Down: Slightly; to more extent or certainly? (6)

KAKURO

1 Across: Most commonly used fuel by commercial vehicles and cargo haulers (6)

2 Across: Critical Path Analysis, abbr. (3)

3 Across: What to spend in Tehran (4)

4 Across: "R" in TRAI (10)

5 Across: Thin strip of wood (4)

6 Across: Big name in Japanese auto industry (6)

7 Across: Most of the time; in most cases (8)

8 Across: Information about recent and important events (7)

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25 Down: Adepts, professionals in their fields (7)

26 Down: An organ or part conveying nervous impulses - "fern feet" anagram? (8)

27 Down: Slightly; to more extent or certainly? (6)

BRIDGE BOUTS

L SUBRAMANIAN

HEED THE WARNING SIGNS

There are some players who indulge in non-stop bidding, often regretting at the outcome. Enjoy today's deal from a match-point event.

Partner opens 1C on first seat and righty overcalls 1H. You bid 2D and LHO raises his partner to 2H. Partner supports you by bidding 3D. RHO being the tireless bidder that he is, bids 3H. You show your spades with a bid of 3S and partner retreats to 4D. RHO does not give up but bids 4H now. You stop the proceedings / bidding circus, by doubling RHO.

Contract: 4H by south; doubled by west.

How the play went: You lead the CJ. Dummy covers with the queen. Partner wins the king, cashes the ace, and exits in C9. Declarer ruffs and cashes the H A-K and is disappointed when you show out. He plays a spade to dummy's ace next and plays another spade. Partner ruffs with the HQ, plays a diamond to your ace. You cash out S K-Q and declarer is down three for + 800 to you. The complete hands were:

SA 8 6 3
HT 8 6
DQT 4
CQ 6 3

SKQ 4 2
H 2
DAJ 9 7 6
CJT 2

W N E S
- - 1C 1H
2D 2H 3D 3H
3S Pass 4D 4H???
dbl All Pass

SA 8 6 3
HT 8 6
DQT 4
CQ 6 3

SKQ 4 2
H 2
DAJ 9 7 6
CJT 2

ST
HQ 5 3
DK 5 3 2
CAK 9 8 4

SJ 9 7 5
HAKJ 9 7 4
D 8
C 7 5

Discussion: As you would have perceived by now, EW has at best +130 in a diamond part score. South could have avoided the debacle by simply jumping to 2H at his first opportunity. 2D by west over 1H overcall suggested 10+, that south did not heed. When you are OUT-GUNNED, it is better to retire from bidding at the earliest opportunity. Even granting 3H is acceptable, the 4H bid, all by himself, was a complete waste of time.

LEXICON

SHAMPAIGN

■ *n.* A fake, insincere, or misleading campaign, particular for political office.

A fair number of these campaigns were never real to begin with. They're shams — or sham-paigns, if you will — designed to snag some free press during the slow months and elevate the would-be candidate's profile. —Ryan Teague Beckwith, "Time to pop the 'sham-paign' bubble," *Lowell Sun*, August 20, 2013



INDIA SHELTER FINANCE CORPORATION LTD.

POSSESSION NOTICE FOR IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

Corporate Office: 6th Floor, Plot No 15, Institutional Area, Sector 44 Gurugram-122003 Haryana Tel: 1800- 532-4444, **BRANCH :** Maharashtra

Whereas, The Undersigned Being The Authorised Officer Of The India Shelter Finance And Corporation Ltd, Under The Securitisation And Reconstruction Of Financial Assets And Enforcement (security) Interest Act,2002 And In Exercise Of Power Conferred Under Section 13(12) Read With Rule 3 Of The Security Interest (enforcement) Rules,2002,issued A Demand Notice On The Date Noted Against The Account As Mentioned Hereinafter, Calling Upon The Borrower And Also The Owner Of The Property/surety To Repay The Amount Within 60 Days From The Date Of The Said Notice. Whereas The Owner Of The Property And The Other Having Failed To Repay The Amount, Notice Is Hereby Given To The Under noted Borrowers And The Public In General That The Undersigned Has Taken Possession Of The Property/ies Described Herein Below In Exercise Of The Powers Conferred On Him/her Under Section 13(4) Of The Said Act Read With Rules 8 & 9 Of The Said Rules On The Dates Mentioned Against Each Account. The Borrower Attention Is Invited To Provisions Of Sub Section (8) Of Section 13 Of The Act, In Respect Of Time Available, to Redeem The Secured Assets. Now, The Borrower In Particular And The Public In General Is Hereby Cautioned Not To Deal With The Property/ies And Any Dealing With The Property/ies Will Be Subject To The Charge Of India Shelter Finance Corporation Ltd For An Amount Mentioned As Below And Interest Thereon, Costs, Etc.

NAME OF THE BORROWER/GUARANTOR (OWNER OF THE PROPERTY) & LOAN ACCOUNT NUMBER	DESCRIPTION OF THE CHARGED /MORTGAGED PROPERTY (ALL THE PART & PARCEL OF THE PROPERTY CONSISTING OF)	DT. OF DEMAND NOTICE, AMOUNT DUE AS ON DATE OF DEMAND NOTICE	DATE OF POSSESSION
Anuradha Pramod Mohite, Pramod Mohite & Parashram Vishnu Mohite RESIDE AT: Milkat No.434, Bhavani Chowk,At Savarde, Tal Tasgaon Dist Sangli-416408 Maharashtra LOAN ACCOUNT NO. LA11VVLONS000005115649	All Piece And Parcel Of Bearing Milkat No.434, Anuramank No.430, And Its land Area 1500 Sq Ft. Simple construction 1500 Sq Ft. Situated At Savarde Tq Tasgaon Dist Sangli Boundary:- East-Property Of Rajaram Vishnu Mohite,West-Property Of Bhagwan Shankar Mane,North-Road, South-Road	DEMAND NOTICE 10-Oct-2025 Rs. 2131058/- (Rupees Twenty One Lakh Thirty One Thousand Five Eight Only) Due As On 10.10.2025 Together With Interest Applicable From 11.10.2025 And Other Charges And Cost Till The Date Of The Payment.	11.09.2026 Physical
KANTABAI JOTIRAM GUND, GAURAV JOTIRAM GUND & JOTIRAM YOGIRAJ GUND RESIDE AT: Gat No.307/2/C, Near Airtel Tower, Neware Omwale Road, Gund Wasti, At Neware Taluka - Malshiras, District - Solapur - 413112 Maharashtra. oundary:- East- Gat No. 307/2/K Out of Plot No. 2, South-Land Of Kiran Nilin Asbe, West- Nevre to Umbare Road, North- Internal Road	All Piece And Parcel Of Gat No.307/2/K, having an area of 30.25 R Sq. Mtrs, out of that non agricultural land, Plot No. 1 ADM 5.00 R Sq. Mtrs (5000.00 Sq.Ft) At Neware, Taluka - Malshiras, District - Solapur - 413112 Maharashtra. oundary:- East- Gat No. 307/2/K Out of Plot No. 2, South-Land Of Kiran Nilin Asbe, West- Nevre to Umbare Road, North- Internal Road	DEMAND NOTICE 12-Jan-2026 Rs. 1667959/- (Rupees Sixteen Lakh Sixty Seven Thousand Nine Hundred Fifty Nine Only) Due As On 10.01.2026 Together With Interest Applicable From 11.01.2026 And Other Charges And Cost Till The Date Of The Payment.	11/09/2026 Physical
PRABHAVATI SANJAY PAWAR, SANJAY JAGANNATH PAWAR & SATISH JAGANNATH PAWAR RESIDE AT: Milkat no. 51, At Post Gopalpur Taluka Pandharpur, Dist Solapur 413304 Maharashtra LOAN ACCOUNT NO. LAPNVLLONS000005150799	All Piece And Parcel Of Milkat no. 51 West Side Part, Admeasuring Area - 435.50 Sq. Mtrs, (i.e 4686.00 Sq. Ft) With Built-up Area- 130.11 Sq. Mtrs, (i.e 1400.00 Sq. Ft), At Post Gopalpur Taluka Pandharpur, Dist Solapur 413304 Maharashtra Boundary:- East- House of Pandurang Yashwant Metkari, West -Road And House of Bhambai Manik Asbe, South -Property of Bhamabai Asbe, North -Property of Mahadev Baliram Asbe	DEMAND NOTICE 11-May-2026 Rs. 1173300/- (Rupees Eleven Lakh Seventy Three Thousand Three Hundred Only) Due As On 10.05.2026 Together With Interest Applicable From 11.05.2026 And Other Charges And Cost Till The Date Of The Payment.	11.09.2026

FOR ANY QUERY PLEASE CONTACT MR. TUSHAR HURDE (+91 7350002453), MR. PRAKASH TANDULKAR (+91 7447426676)

PLACE: Madhya Pradesh
DATE: 13.09.2026

(AUTHORIZED OFFICER)
INDIA SHELTER FINANCE CORPORATION LTD

SVATANTRA MICRO HOUSING FINANCE CORPORATION LTD.

Office no. 5 & 6, 11th Floor, E Wing, Times Square, Andheri-Kurla Road, Marol, Andheri (E), Mumbai 400059. TEL- 8001234427 / +91 22 69609000/100 Email : collections@smfhindia.com



AUCTION-CUM-TENDER SALE NOTICE TO GENERAL PUBLIC

Whereas under section 13(2) of the 'Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002, the Authorized Officer has issued demand notices as mentioned below in table for the recovery as mentioned from the borrowers/guarantors/mortgagors (herein referred to as borrowers). Further, In exercise of powers contained in the 'Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002, the Authorized Officer has taken the possessions of the under mentioned secured assets which are held as securities in respect of Loan/credit facilities granted to them. Whereas sale of the secured asset/s is to be made through Public auction cum Tender, for recovery of the secured debt due to **Svatantra Micro Housing Finance Corporation Ltd., (SMHFC)**. The General Public is invited to bid either personally or by a duly authorised agent.

Details of borrowers/amount outstanding/Properties/Reserve Price/EMD Amount, Date & Time of Deposit of EMD/Date & Time of Inspection/Date & Time of Auction:

Name & Address of Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgagors	Date of Demand Notice Amount outstanding Possession Date	Description of properties along with name of mortgagors (Owner of the property)	Reserve Price & Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)
Mr. Shivaji Babar Mr. Amol Babar	09/04/2026 Rs.3,00,445/- (Rs Three Lakh Four Hundred Forty-Five Only) Possession Date: 13/08/2026	Milkat No 371, Taluka Kagal, Karanjivane, Kolhapur, Maharashtra, 416219	Rs.5.70 Lacs Rs.57,000/-
Mr. Sandip Patil Mr. Vishnu Patil Mrs. Vimal Patil	14/05/2026 Rs.1,87,278/- (Rs One Lakh Eighty-Seven Thousand Two Hundred Seventy-Eight Only) Possession Date: 13/08/2026	Grampanchayat Property No.61, Taluka- Gaganavada, Kherivade, Kolhapur, Maharashtra, 416205	Rs.5.70 Lacs Rs.57,000/-
Mr. Mayur Dayanand More Mr. Dayanand Babasaheb More Mrs. Sarika Dayanand More	14/05/2026 Rs. 19,07,950/- (Rupees Nineteen Lakh Seven Thousand Nine Hundred Fifty Only) Possession Date: 12/08/2026	Plot No.06, Survey No.482/2, Dudhalwasti, Ghatagewadi Road, at Jath, Sangli, Maharashtra, 416404	Rs.23.00 Lacs Rs.2,30,000 /-
Mrs. Baanu Mainoddin Chanda Mr. Ilyas Mainoddin Chanda	14/05/2026 Rs. 2,01,794/- (Rupees Two Lakh One Thousand Seven Hundred Ninety-Four Only) Possession Date: 11/08/2026	Flat/Unit No. 311, Floor No. 2, Flat Type- 1 BHK of Building called Gat No. 979/1 Plot No. 1 Building No. 20 in the Project Ray Nagar Housing Project situated at Gat No. 722/2/F723, 697, 707, 726, 724, 725, 764, 721, 845, 728, 710, 755, 729/1, 978/3, 979/1, 963/1, 963/2, 963/3, 977/1, 981/1, 982/1, 982/2 At Kumbhari, Solapur-South, Solapur, 413006	Rs.4.00 Lacs Rs.40,000/-
Mr. Najir Mehabub Shaikh Mrs. Shamim Najir Shaikh	08/06/2026 Rs. 14,04,773/- (Rupees Fourteen Lakh Four Thousand Seven Hundred Seventy-Three Only) Possession Date: 31/08/2026	Flat/Unit No. G-2, Floor No. 0, Flat Type- 1 BHK of Building called B in the Project Om Shanti Nagar situated at Survey No. 167/1A/1/1A (Old Gat No. 187), CTS No. 2690, at Daund, Near Swami Samarth Mandir, Shalimar Chowk, Taluka-Daund, District- Pune - 413801	Rs. 8.95 Lacs Rs.89,500/-
Mr. Ravi Anil Telangi Mrs. Laxmi Anil Telangi	08/06/2026 Rs. 9,36,115/- (Rupees Nine Lakh Thirty-Six Thousand One Hundred Fifty-Five Only) Possession Date: 29/08/2026	Plot No.7A out of Survey No.692/3(New Survey No.302/3), Bamni Road, at Miraj, Taluka- Miraj, Sangli, Maharashtra, 416410	Rs.10.85 Lacs Rs.1,08,500/-
Mr. Namadev Ashok Dhumal Mr. Ashok Namdev Dhumal Mrs. Triveni Namdev Dhumal Mrs. Changuana Ashok Dhumal	08/06/2026 Rs. 18,49,674/- (Rupees Eighteen Lakh Forty-Nine Thousand Six Hundred Seventy-Four Only) Possession Date: 29/08/2026	Plot No.31 out of survey No.31/1 (Old Survey No.36/1), Ayodhya Nagar, at Miraj, Taluka-Miraj, Sangli, Maharashtra, 416410	Rs.21.70 Lacs Rs.2,17,000/-
Mr. Swarup Sudhir Pachange Mr. Sudhir D Pachange Mrs. Gauri Jaydeep Chavan Mrs. Sushma S Pachange	08/06/2026 Rs. 24,12,427/- (Rupees Twenty-Four Lakh Twelve Thousand Four Hundred Twenty-Seven Only) Possession Date: 01/09/2026	Flat/Unit No. 7, Floor No. 1, Flat Type - 1 BHK of Building called Laxmi Kamal Vishwa in the Project Laxmi Kamal Vishwa Chsl situated at Survey No.180 (Old Survey No.152), Hissa No. 5A and Hissa No. 16A, At Fursungi, Taluka: Haveli, District: Pune 412308	Rs. 18.00 Lacs Rs.1,80,000/-

◆ Date and Time of Inspection:- 10-10-2026 - 11.00 AM to 1.00 PM ◆ Last date & time of deposit of EMD: 12-10-2026 up to 5.00 PM ◆ Date and Time of Auction : 14-10-2026 - 11.00 AM to 12.00 PM

TERMS AND CONDITIONS OF E-AUCTION SALE: The sale shall be subject to the Terms & Conditions prescribed in the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002 and to the following further conditions:
i. The properties are being sold on 'AS IS WHEREAS' BASIS.
ii. The particulars of Secured Assets specified in the Schedule herein above have been stated to the best of the information of the Authorised Officer, but the Authorised Officer shall not be answerable for any error, misstatement or omission in this proclamation.
iii. The secured assets will not be sold below the reserve price.
iv. The auction sale will be "through Auction-Cum-Tender".
v. The bidders are also advised for detailed terms and conditions The interested bidders shall deposit the EMD by way of Demand Draft favoring "SMHFC LTD" or through NEFT/RTGS A/c No. **00608940000020** IFSC Code: **HDFC0002838** " as per above mentioned account numbers The draft should not be of a Cooperative-Bank. vi. Bidder is to submit these documents through e-mail to the Authorised Officer at e-mail address and also to submit self-attested hard copies of these documents (Demand Draft in original) to the Authorised Officer, at the Branch address mentioned herein above in the envelope super scribing as 'Bid in the A/C (mention the account Name)
vii. Others detailed Terms and Conditions available on website www.svatantramhfc.com. Further enquiries may be clarified with the Authorized Officer, SMHFC (+91 8657949180), Mr.Dattatray Rajguru (+91 8291297005), Mr. Anil Aher (+918657582030), Mr. Prasann Chauhkhande (+91 8668275765), Mr. Anil Patil (+91 9167220728) & Mr. Sharik Saudagar (+91 887966943) or 022-26101076-79 Email-sharik.saudagar@svatantramhfc.com.

Authorised Officer
Svatantra Micro Housing Finance Corporation Ltd (SMHFC)
(Secured Creditor)

Annexure 13 Form No. 22
[See Regulation 37(1)] By All Permissible Mode

OFFICE OF THE RECOVERY OFFICER
DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL PUNE
Unit No. 307 to 310, 3rd Floor, Kakade Biz Icon Building, Shivaji Nagar, Pune-411005.

Date : 04/09/2026
Date of Auction Sale : 23/10/2026

RC. No. 1/2021

Proclamation of Sale: Immovable Property

Proclamation of Sale Under Rules 37, 38, AND 52, 53 of Second Schedule to the Income Tax Act, 1961 Read with the Recovery of Debts Due Debts Due To Banks and Financial Institutions (RDBB) Act, 1993
Indian Overseas Bank
Versus
Millenium Mobility Pvt. Ltd. & Ors.

Whereas Recovery Certificate No. RC/1/2021 in OA No.397/2014 drawn up by the Hon'ble Presiding Officer, **DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL PUNE** for the recovery of the sum of **Rs. 18,54,97,562.00 (Rupees Eighteen Crores Fifty Four Lakhs Ninety Seven Thousands Five Hundred Sixty Two Only)**, along with pendent life and future interest @ 13.50% w.e.f. 14/02/2019 till realization with costs of **Rs.1,75,255 (Rupees One Lakh Seventy five Thousand Two Hundred Fifty Five Only)** from the CDs and you, the CDs, failed to repay the dues of the Certificate Holder Bank(S)/Financial Institution(s).

And whereas the undersigned has ordered the sale of the Mortgaged/Attached properties as mentioned in the Schedule hereunder towards satisfaction of the said Recovery Certificate. Notice is hereby given that in absence of any order of postponement, the said property(s) shall be sold on **23/10/2026 between 11:00 AM to 01:00 PM** by e-auction and bidding shall take place through **'Online Electronic Bidding'** through the website: **assets.matexnetauctions.com**

The intending bidders are advised to refer to the detailed terms and conditions displayed at the site of the property, on the Notice Board of the Recovery Officer, on the website **http://drt.gov.in** and in the website of the e-auction service provider **assets.matexnetauctions.com**. For any other clarification, the undersigned may be contacted either in person or over the phone OR contact the Authorised Bank Officer/ Auction Service provider, whose details are as follows:

Name of the CH Branch	Indian Overseas Bank
Name of the Nodal Branch & Address	2nd Floor, 272, Shaniwar Peth, Opposite Omkareshwar Temple, Pune-411030.
Branch Phone No.	LANDLINE : 020-25660210 /25660134
Bank official Designated and Mobile No.	Mr. Nitesh Kumar, Chief Manager, Mobile - 8925952584
Name of Empanelled Agency for E Auction	M/s. Matex Technologies Private Limited
Address	37/22, Chamiers Towers, 6th Floor, Chamiers Road, Teynampet, Chennai-600018.
Phone No.	Ms. Induja K. - 9150757333, Mr. Dhanush - 9500173312.
E-mail Address	solutions@matexnet.com
Website address	assets.matexauction.com
Contact Person	Ms. Induja K. - 9150757333, Mr. Dhanush - 9500173312.

The sale will be of the properties of defendants/ CDs above named, as mentioned in the schedule below & the liabilities and claims attaching to the said properties, so far as they have been ascertained, are those specified in the schedule

The property will be put up for sale in the lot specified in the schedule. If the amount to be realized is satisfied by the sale of portion of the property, the sale shall be immediately stopped with respect to the remainder. The sale will also be stopped if, before any lot is knocked down the arrears mentioned in the said certificate+ interest+costs (including cost of sale) are tendered to the officer conducting the sale or proof is given to his satisfaction that the amount of such certificate, interest and costs has been paid to the undersigned.

At the sale, the public generally are invited to bid either personally or by duly Authorised agent. No officer or other person, having any duty to perform in connection with this sale shall, however, either directly or indirectly, bid for, acquire attempt to acquire any interest in the properties sold.

The sale shall be subject to conditions prescribed in the second schedule to the Income Tax Act, 1961 and the rules made thereunder and to the following further conditions

I) The particulars specified in the annexed schedule below have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned, but the undersigned shall not be answerable for any error, misstatement or omission in the proclamation.

II) The Reserve Price (DISTRESS VALUE) below mentioned which the property shall not be sold.

III) The amount by which the bidding is to be increased, shall be Rs. 50,000/- (Rs. Fifty Thousand Only) In the event of any dispute arising as to the amount bid or as to the bidder the lot shall at once be again put up for auction or may be cancelled. If there is only one bidder the e auction will commence with one increment over and above the Reserve price.

IV) The highest bidder shall be declared to be the purchaser of any lot provided always that he/she/they are legally qualified to bid and provided further the amount bid by him/her/they is not less than the reserve price. It shall be in the discretion of the undersigned to decline acceptance of the highest bid when the price offered appears so clearly inadequate as to make it inadvisable to do so.

V) Each intending bidders shall be required to deposit Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) & all required documents before 19-10-2026 upto 05.00 pm. EMD to be deposited by way of Demand Draft in favour of RECOVERY OFFICER, DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL PUNE and submit details / required document R.O. DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL PUNE as under :
A) Online Auction Bid Form (Duly Signed). B) Declaration by Bidder/s (Duly Signed). C) Details of the Property, D) Copy of PAN Card, E) Address Proof and Identity Proof, F) E-mail ID, Mobile No. G) In case of the company - any other document, confirming representation / attorney of the company, H) DD/Pay Order / Receipt / Counter foil and Statement of Account by which such amount remitted to the Account of Recovery Officer, DRT, Pune.
Note : EMD & all required documents deposited after the required timeline shall not be considered eligible for participation in the auction.)

VII) Last date for receipt of EMD and all required documents is **19/10/2026 till 05.00 pm**. EMD/required documents, received after due date & time shall be rejected & the amount paid towards the EMD shall be returned to them by way of cheque/option given by them in the E-Auction Form. Required documents/correspondence can be submitted online at **ro-drtpunegov.in** or physically in the RO office - DRT Pune in the required timeline. Demand Drafts to be deposited in the RO-Office, DRT Pune.

V) Any person desirous of participating in the bidding process is required to have a valid digital signature certificate issued by the competent authority. It is the sole responsibility of the bidder to obtain the said digital signature certificate, active-email id and a computer terminal/system with internet connection to enable him/her to participate in the bidding.

VII) Any issue with regard to digital signature certificate and connectivity during the course of online bidding shall be the sole responsibility of the bidder and no claims in this regard shall be entertained.

VIII) If the bid is increased within the last 5 minutes of the given time of auction, the auction time is further extended by additional time of 5 minutes to enable the other bidders to increment their bids & the auction process commences to an end if no further increment(s) is/are made within the extended time of 5 minutes. In case of movable/immovable property the price of each lot shall be paid at the time of sale or as soon after as the officer holding the sale directs, and in default of payment, the property shall forthwith be again put up for auction for resale.

VIII) The successful bidder shall have to pay 25% of the sale proceeds after adjustment of EMD on being knocked down by next day through Demand draft/ Banker Cheque /Pay order etc or by online through RTGS into the Account No. 60583099502 in the name of "Recovery Officer - DRT, Pune - held with the BANK OF MAHARASHTRA IFSC Code No. MAHB0000750. If the next day is Holiday or Sunday, then on next first office day. The purchaser shall deposit the balance 75% of the sale proceeds on or before 15th day from the date of sale of the property, exclusive of such day, or if the 15th day be Sunday or other Holiday, then on the first office day after the 15th day by prescribed mode as stated above. In addition to the above the purchaser shall also deposit Pledge fee with Recovery Officer, DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL PUNE @ 2% upto Rs.1,000/- and @ 1% of the excess of the said amount of Rs. 1,000/- In the recovery Officer account mentioned above.

IX) In case of default of payment within the prescribed period, the deposit, after defraying the expenses of the sale, may, if the undersigned thinks fit, shall be forfeited to the Government and the defaulting purchaser shall forfeit all claims to the property or to any part of the sum for which it may subsequently be sold. The property shall be resold after the issue of fresh proclamation of sale. Highest bidder shall not have any right/title over the property until the sale is confirmed by the Recovery Officer, DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL PUNE

X) The amount of EMD deposited by the unsuccessful bidders in the form of DD, the same will be returned by hand. Original ID proof of the photocopy sent with the E-Auction EMD Form has to be brought. No interest shall be paid on EMD amount

XI) Request for inclusion/substitution in the sale certificate of names of any person(s) other than those mentioned in the E-Auction EMD Form shall not be entertained.

XII) In case of more than one items of property brought for sale, the sale of such properties will be as per the convenience and it is not obligatory to go serially as mentioned in the sale notice.

XIII)NRI Bidders must necessarily enclose a copy of photo page of their passport route their bid duly endorsed by Indian Mission (Embassy)

XIV) The movable /immovable property is being sold on **"As is where is and as is what is"** basis and is subject to Publication charges, revenue and other Encumbrances as per rules. The undersigned reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids, if found unreasonable or may postpone the auction at any time without assigning any reason.

Details of this Proclamation of sale can be viewed at the website www.drt.gov.in/assets.matexnetauctions.com

The Earnest money Deposit (EMD), Reserve Price and Bid Increase, be fixed as follows :

Lot No.	Details of Property	EMD Amount (In Rs.)	Reserve Price (In Rs.) Market Value	Bid Increase in the multiple of (In Rs.)
1)	Lot 1 - All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 144/B ad measuring 1H 90 R situate at village Theur, Taluka Haveli, District Pune within the registration sub district of Pune. All that piece and parcel of the land admeasuring 85 R out of an area admeasuring 06 H 10 R along with Potkharaba situated at Old S.No. 75 and New Gat No. 144 A village Theur Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune and within the jurisdiction of Sub Registrar, Haveli No VI (As per the latest revenue record, the No. 144A & 144B have been amalgamated and have been allotted Gat No. 144).	37,24,000/- 16,66,000/-	3,72,40,000/- 1,66,60,000/-	50,000/- 50,000/-
	Lot 2 - All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 328/2 admeasuring about 81 R out of total area 3H 91 R, situated at village Theur, Tal Haveli, Dist. Pune and within the locale limits of Grampanchayat Theur.	17,01,000/-	1,70,10,000/-	50,000/-
	Lot 3 - All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 146, admeasuring about 2H 03 R situated at village Theur Pune, Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune and within the local limits of Grampanchayat Theur and the said land is Bounded as under - On or towards East — By Gat No. 147. On or towards South- By Gat No. 144. On or towards West — By Gat No. 145, On or towards North — By Gat No. 161.	39,78,800/-	3,97,88,000/-	50,000/-
	Lot 4 : a) All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 161, admeasuring about 91 R including well out of the total land admeasuring 3 H 02 R situated at village Theur, Pune, Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune. b) All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 161, admeasuring about 31 R out of the total land ad measuring 3 H 02 R situated at village T heur, Pu ne Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pu ne. c) All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 161, admeasuring about 60 R out of the total land ad measuring 3 H 02 R situated at village Theur, Pune, Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune. And within the local limits Grampanchayat Theur. LOT 5 : All that piece and parcel of the land admeasuring 3 H 23.32 R alongwith Potkharaba situated at Gat No. 328 B at Village T heur Taluka Haveli, Dist. Pune and within the jurisdiction of Sub Registrar Haveli No. VI. All that part & parcel of the land bearing gat No. 328/1 admeasuring 3 Hector 02 R situated at Theur Village, Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune. (As per the latest revenue record, Gat No. 328 and 328/1 have been amalgamated and have been allotted Gat No. 328)	35,57,200/- 67,89,700/- 63,42,000/-	3,56,72,000/- 6,78,97,000/- 6,34,20,000/-	50,000/- 50,000/- 50,000/-

Schedule of Property :

Lot No.	Description of property to be Sold	Revenue assessed upon the property or part thereof	Details of any encumbrances to which the property is liable	Claim if any which have been put forward to the property and any other known bearing on its nature and value
	Lot 1 - All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 144/B ad measuring 1H 90 R situate at village Theur, Taluka Haveli, District Pu ne within the registration sub-district of Pune. All that piece and parcel of the land admeasuring 85 R out of an area admeasuring 06 H 10 R along with Potkharaba situated at Old S.No. 75 and New Gat No. 144 A village Theur Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune and within the jurisdiction of Sub Registrar, Haveli No VI (As per the latest revenue record, the No. 144A & 144B have been amalgamated and have been allotted Gat No. 144). Lot 2 - All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 328/2 ad measuring about 81 R out of total area 3H 91 R, situated at village Theur, Tal Haveli, Dist. Pune and within the locale limits of Grampanchayat Theur. Lot 3 - All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 146, admeasuring about 2H 03 R situated at village Theur Pune, Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune and within the local limits of Grampanchayat Theur and the said land is Bounded as under - On or towards East — By Gat No. 147 On or towards South- By Gat No. 144 On or towards West — By Gat No. 145, On or towards North — By Gat No. 161. Lot 4 : a) All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 161, admeasuring about 91 R including well out of the total land admeasuring 3 H 02 R situated at village Theur, Pune, Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune. b) All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 161, admeasuring about 31 R out of the total land ad measuring 3 H 02 R situated at village Theur, Pu ne Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pu ne. c) All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Gat No. 161, admeasuring about 60 R out of the total land ad measuring 3 H 02 R situated at village Theur, Pune, Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune. And within the local limits Grampanchayat Theur. LOT 5 : All that piece and parcel of the land ADMEASURING 3 H 23.32 R alongwith Potkharaba situated at Gat No. 328 B at Village Theur Taluka Haveli, Dist. Pu ne and within the jurisdiction of Sub Registrar Haveli No. VI. All that part & parcel of the land bearing gat No. 328/1 admeasuring 3 Hector 02 R situated at Theur Village, Tal. Haveli, Dist. Pune. (As per the latest revenue record, the Gat No. 328 & 328/1 have been amalgamated and have been allotted Gat No. 328.)	Not Known	Not Known	Not Known

1) Bidders are advised to go through the website for detailed terms and conditions of auction sale before submitting their bids and taking part in the E-auction sale proceedings. Other terms and conditions are also available with Recovery Officer, DRT, Pune and Branch Manager of CH bank, 3) The above conditions are in addition to the Terms & Conditions contained in the auction bid format and website. 4) Prospective bidders are advised to peruse the copies of title deeds, if any, available with the bank and also carry out their own inquiries to satisfy themselves regarding encumbrances, if any, over the property, 5) The Properties can be inspected on **09/10/2026 & 16/10/2026 between 11:00 AM to 05:00 P.M.** for inspection please contact **Mr. Nitesh Kumar, Chief Manager, Mobile - 8925952584**. Recovery Officer has the absolute right to accept or reject any bid or bids or to postpone or cancel the sale without assigning any reason. 6) The sale shall be subjct to confirmation by Recovery Officer, Given under my hand and seal on this date **04/09/2026**.

Seal of the Tribunal

(Ravikant Vinayak Yadav)
Recovery Officer-I
Debts Recovery Tribunal, Pune



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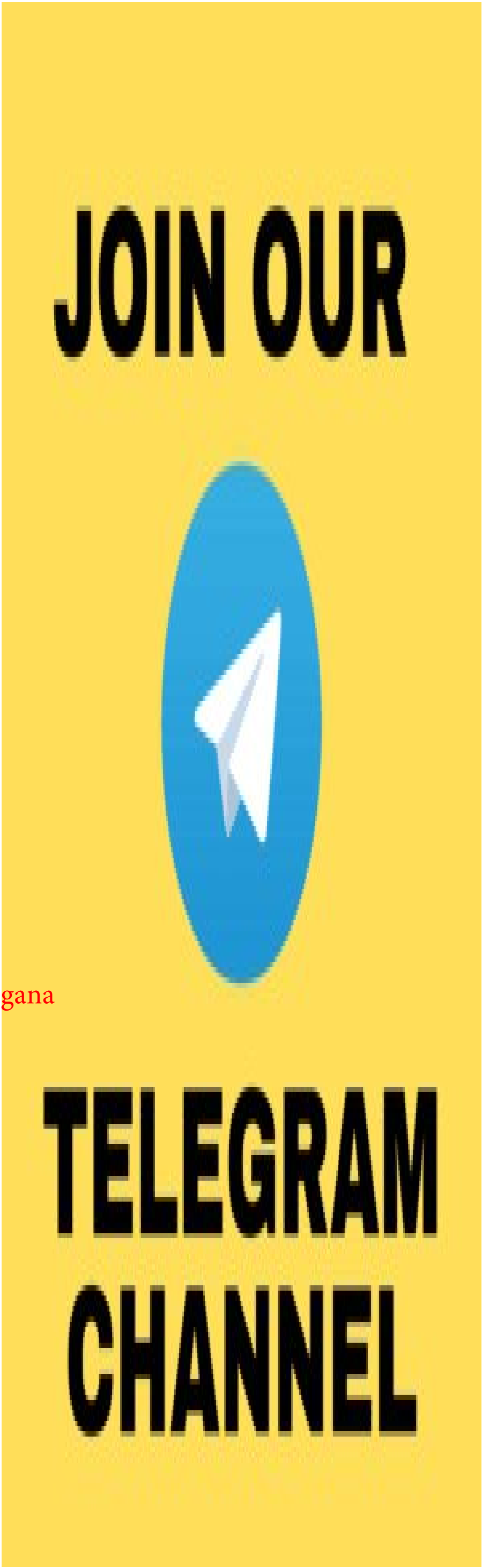
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